

A HOTPAST STORY

I KNOW WHO YOU DID LAST SUMMER

BOOK 2

BESTSELLING AUTHOR
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I Know Who You Did Last Summer, Book 2

A Hotpast Story

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Cerulean

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I Know Who You Did Last Summer, Book 2

Everything seemed to be back on track for Ryan and Emmie after a year apart. They were stronger than ever, with Emmie even talking about starting a family. But the accidental discovery of two condom wrappers in her pocket opened Ryan's eyes and plunged him into a desperate search for the truth about what really happened during their break.

After Emmie confessed to a one-night stand, Ryan tried to move forward, convinced he could handle her past. But when an anonymous email arrives with an explicit video of Emmie with another man, Ryan is pulled into a dark world of secrets he never imagined. As he digs deeper to uncover the sender's identity and the truth behind the video, intrigue turns to obsession, and each new revelation brings him closer to a devastating choice.

With his marriage and sanity on the line, Ryan must confront the most unsettling question of all: can he face the truth about Emmie... and about himself?

In Book 2 of *I Know What You Did Last Summer*, the suspense escalates, pushing Ryan to the very edge as he faces a shocking choice that will leave readers breathless and eager for what's next.

'*I Know What You Did Last Summer, Book 2*' is a hotpast story featuring explicit adult scenes and explores themes such as cuckolding, hotwife and wife-sharing.

Chapter One

What I'd seen on the video of Emmie stayed with me all day while I was at work, refusing to loosen its grip on my mind. As I walked up to our front door that Monday evening, the cool autumn air did nothing to shake off the disquiet clinging to me. My thoughts were tangled in a mess of suspicion, jealousy, and something else—something dark and yet arousing—that I couldn't clear from my head. I hesitated momentarily on the doorstep, standing there, my fingers toying with the keys in my pocket, before eventually unlocking the door and stepping inside.

"Emmie?" I called out, kicking off my shoes and setting my workbag down.

"In the kitchen!" came her voice, warm and friendly as though nothing were amiss, oblivious to my turmoil.

I walked in, trying to keep my expression neutral. She was at the counter, slicing some vegetables, her wavy blonde hair pulled back into a ponytail. The sight of her—beautiful, casual, just doing something as simple as cooking—stirred that mix of emotions all over again. How could someone who seemed so perfect and down-to-earth have such a secret? How could she have been that woman on her knees, sucking another man so wantonly? My heart twisted at the memory.

"How was work?" she asked, barely looking up.

"Not great, if I'm honest," I replied, stepping closer to peek at what she was cooking—a stir fry, it seemed. "How was your day?"

She shrugged, tossing the vegetables into the sizzling pan. “Busy. Nate was all over me for those reports. And there’s still some mess left from last week’s campaign I’m trying to wrap up.”

Nate was her boss. A former client of hers at her previous company, when she’d decided to leave during our time apart, Nate had been good enough to give her the opportunity for a new start. Part of the reason we’d split was her over-dedication to her last job. Her previous boss, Ethan, had worked her to the bone and it frustrated me. But now, Nate let her work flexible hours. She always had her weekends free. It was much better and part of the reason I decided to give our marriage another go.

I watched her as she stirred the vegetables around the pan, at ease, seemingly happy and relaxed. It was strange, to see her like this after watching that video. My Emmie, in our kitchen, cooking dinner like an innocent housewife. But inside, I knew the things she’d done.

“So why was work not great?” she asked, looking up to see why I was watching her.

“Helen pulled me into the office,” I sighed, leaning against the counter, “It looks like I’m dealing with Mitch again.”

Emmie stilled for just a second, her hand hovering above the pan before she resumed stirring. “Mitchell Davison? Urgh.”

“Yeah,” I said, my eyes narrowing slightly as I watched her. “I know, right? Sophie’s taking on a new account, some big deal, and Helen wants me to take Mitch back, despite the trouble he gave me last time.”

She gave a short nod, her eyes fixed on the pan. “Well, I hope he’s not as much of a dick as he was last time you dealt with him.”

“A dick is one way to put it,” I said, trying to keep my tone light. I couldn’t tell if her reaction was anything more than surprise, but I’d learned one thing—Emmie was good at hiding things when she wanted to. “I’m not exactly thrilled about it, but it is what it is.”

“Right,” she murmured, her gaze still not meeting mine. “Well, maybe it won’t be that bad. He might’ve changed since you last worked with him.”

I raised an eyebrow, but let it drop, my eyes lingering on her for a moment longer before I turned away to grab a glass from the cabinet. “I doubt it,” I replied, filling the glass with juice. “He’s been a pain in my ass since we were at school. Leopards don’t change their spots but we’ll see.”

We ate dinner mostly in silence, the clinking of forks and knives on plates filling the space between us. I tried to ignore the growing sense of tension

in the air, but it seemed impossible. I'd catch Emmie watching me out of the corner of her eye, her lips parting like she wanted to say something, but she'd only press them shut again and look away.

After dinner, Emmie offered to do the dishes, and I took the opportunity to clear my head. I stepped out onto the back patio, leaning against the railing as I stared up at the star-filled sky. My thoughts wandered back to everything that had happened in the past week—the condoms, the confession about Shaun and now the emails and the video. Part of me wanted to take the bull by the horns, go back into the house, confront her, demand to know everything—but I couldn't do that. Not yet.

There had to be more to that video. The way it ended, with Emmie turning around and the stranger just beginning to have sex with her, made me suspect it had been edited, or cut short. No one would stop a video there, not so abruptly as that. There had to be more to it. Surely, whoever he was, he'd recorded himself having sex? Perhaps there was more video before she started sucking him too.

Curiosity ate away at me and I looked up at the stars above me. If there was more video, would I want to see it? What if the guy came on her face? Or her boobs? It was difficult enough watching her suck him. How much harder would it be to watch him enjoy her and then finish on her?

I wanted to know—no, I *needed* to know—if there were further parts to the video. If there was, I needed to see them, as weird as that felt to admit to myself.

I should speak to her now. Tell her what I'd seen, maybe even show her the email and the video and demand that she tell me everything. But if I did, I was sure I'd lose any chance I had of getting the full story—of knowing what happened that night. She'd already shut me down from talking about Shaun—if that was even his real name—so she'd find some way of blocking me from finding out any more or ever seeing the rest of the recording. I knew Emmie. A direct confrontation wasn't the way forward.

Eventually, I headed back inside, trying to push those thoughts aside for the rest of the evening. Emmie was in the living room, curled up on the sofa, a blanket draped over her as she watched the television. I joined her, sitting close but not quite touching, feeling the awkwardness between us like an invisible barrier. We made small talk about the show she was watching, but the conversation never really flowed. I couldn't forget the dilemma I faced but I tried my best to relax.

A little later, Emmie turned off the TV and stretched, glancing over at me. “I think I’m going to head up,” she said, giving me a soft smile. “You coming?”

“Yeah, I’ll be up in a minute,” I replied, watching her as she stood and headed for the stairs. I waited until she was halfway up before following, still weighed down by my thoughts.

We got ready for bed in relative silence, each of us lost in our own thoughts. Emmie stood in front of the mirror, slowly pulling her top over her head, revealing her bare skin, her large breasts full and soft, the cool light of the bedside lamp highlighting her stiffening nipples as she unclasped her bra and tossed it to the side. She unbuttoned her jeans, sliding them down her legs, her hips swaying slightly as she stepped out of them. I watched her, loving the way her body moved, and as she kicked off her panties, I enjoyed the sight of her smooth pussy mound. I felt my cock twitch at the sight of her nakedness but as much as I wanted her, a dark thought clawed at the edges of my mind—another man had seen her like this too. Naked. Her bare breasts and soft pussy. Another man had touched her, known her, in ways that I thought only I had.

She pulled on her sleep shorts, the fabric clinging to her hips, before turning to look at me, her gaze catching mine for a brief moment. As we slipped under the covers, Emmie turned to me, her hazel eyes searching mine. “You sure you’re okay?” she asked, her voice gentle. “You’ve been quiet all night.”

I forced a smile, nodding. “Yeah. Just... pissed at the Mitch thing. And tired, I guess. It’s been a long day.”

She nodded, her gaze lingering on mine before she leaned in, her lips brushing against my cheek. “I love you, you know that?” she whispered.

“I love you too,” I replied, my voice thick, and for a moment, I almost believed it could be that simple—that love alone could erase the doubts that clouded my thoughts and help me to move on.

Emmie, still topless, snuggled closer, her body warm against mine, and I closed my eyes, trying to let the feeling of her in my arms be enough to drown out everything else. But the image of her on her knees, her lips wrapped around that stranger’s long, thick cock, kept flashing in my mind, and I felt myself growing hard against her. She shifted slightly, noticing, and a soft smile played on her lips.

“Seems like you’re not that tired after all,” she murmured, her hand sliding down between us, her fingers curling around me.

I let out a shaky breath, trying to focus on Emmie—the warmth of her body, the way her fingers wrapped around me with that familiar touch that I knew so well. But even as her hand moved, I couldn’t help the images that flooded my mind. Her lips, those same lips now pressing against my neck, had once been wrapped around another man’s cock, her mouth working him with the same care and hunger she’d given me all these years. My breath hitched, the thought sending a mix of jealousy and arousal coursing through me.

“Em,” I whispered, my voice rougher than I intended, almost a growl. “Suck me.”

Emmie looked up at me, her hazel eyes widening slightly at my request. There was a flicker of something—surprise, maybe even curiosity—but she didn’t question it. Slowly, she shifted down the bed, her lips brushing over my chest, her breath warm against my skin. She kissed lower, her tongue flicking out to trace the line of my hip, and I groaned, my body tensing in anticipation.

I watched her, the sight of her head moving down, her mouth parting as she took me between her lips. My hand tangled in her blonde waves, not forceful, but guiding, wanting her to take more of me, to erase the thoughts that tormented me. She was my wife, my Emmie, yet all I could think about was that video—her mouth on another man, the way she’d looked so lost in what she was doing like she was enjoying every moment. Was she enjoying this now as much as she had then? Did I measure up? My cock wasn’t as big as the one in the video. Was I enough?

Her eyes flicked up to meet mine, and I saw something there—something that looked like concern, maybe even a question. I forced a smile, my hand tightening in her hair as I pushed my hips up, wanting her to take me deeper, to drown out the doubts. She complied, her lips sliding down my length, her tongue teasing against the base of my shaft. A groan slipped from my lips, and for a moment, I closed my eyes, letting myself get lost in the sensation.

A couple of minutes later, I needed more. I needed to be inside her, to claim her in a way that pushed every doubt, every jealous thought, out of my mind. I pulled her up, my mouth crashing against hers, tasting my

precum on her lips. I rolled her over, positioning myself above her, her legs parting eagerly as I settled between them.

The tip of my cock probed blindly between her thighs until the head found her wet heat. I entered her quickly, almost desperately, my hips driving forward with an intensity that surprised even me. Emmie gasped, her hands clutching at my shoulders, her eyes locking onto mine. There was something there—something raw and vulnerable, and for a second, I almost faltered. But then she wrapped her legs around me, pulling me deeper, and I lost myself in her.

I moved faster, harder, trying to chase away the images that haunted me. But they wouldn't leave. Every thrust seemed to bring them back—her body with someone else, her lust for another man. When we first got together, did she compare me to him? Did she still? My heart pounded, my breath coming in ragged gasps as I pushed deeper, needing to prove something to myself, to her.

The tension built too quickly, the pressure overwhelming me. I tried to hold back, to make it last, but it was no use. The jealousy, the arousal, the need to establish her as mine—it all surged to the surface, and before I knew it, I was cumming, my balls crashing against her ass as I buried myself into her. My body shuddered as I came, a strangled groan escaping my lips.

I collapsed beside her, my chest heaving, a wave of shame washing over me. I'd finished too soon, driven by something dark and twisted that I couldn't quite understand. Emmie was quiet for a moment, her hand resting lightly on my chest, her fingers tracing gentle patterns over my skin.

"You okay?" she asked, her voice soft, her eyes searching mine. "That was quite... something."

"Yeah," I lied, forcing a smile. "Just work tension, maybe? I guess I needed to let it out."

"Well, it was fun!" She giggled, her gaze lingering on mine for a moment before she turned away, her body curling up beneath the blankets. I watched her, my heart heavy, the curiosity still bothering me. I wanted to reach out, to pull her close, to make everything right—but instead, I just lay there, staring at the ceiling, catching my breath, wondering where I went from here.

What was happening to me? How was I ever going to get that stupid video out of my head?

I closed my eyes but just as I was beginning to drift off, I heard the soft buzz of Emmie's phone vibrating on her nightstand. She groaned, and I watched her reaching over to grab it, her eyes squinting at the screen. She sighed softly, her fingers tapping quickly before she set the phone back down and turned over, her back to me once again.

I caught a glimpse of the name on the screen—it was Jen—and my curiosity awakened again. What could Jen be texting about this late at night? I lay still, my ears straining to hear, but Emmie was silent. She slipped out of bed a few minutes later, her bare feet padding softly against the floor as she made her way to the bathroom, her phone clutched in her hand.

I listened, my heart thudding in my chest, straining to hear anything over the rush of blood in my ears. I could barely make out her voice, low and urgent, but I couldn't hear what she was saying. Was I being paranoid, or was there something further going on between Emmie and her sister?

I was about to get out of bed to eavesdrop—and say I was checking that everything was okay if I got caught—but just as I moved to swing my legs out from beneath the covers, she came back to bed, her expression unreadable as she slipped in beside me. I didn't say anything, just closed my eyes, my mind racing with questions I couldn't ask.

What could she and Jen possibly be hiding? And how far would I have to go to find out the truth?

Chapter Two

The weight of everything from the night before clung to me as I sat at my desk, trying to focus on the work in front of me. The video of Emmie was like a splinter in my mind—sharp, intrusive, impossible to ignore. It played on a loop in my head, and each time, the questions piled higher. Who had sent it? Was there more to come? And why now? I needed answers, but I wasn't ready to confront Emmie just yet. Not until I knew more—not until I could be sure of what I was dealing with.

The office felt unusually quiet for a Tuesday. The soft hum of computers and the occasional ring of a phone provided a steady background, but I found myself struggling to concentrate, my mouse pointer constantly hovering over my inbox. Would another email come? I both dreaded it and felt an odd sense of anticipation, the thought of another message feeding my curiosity. I had to stay sharp, to figure this out before it all spiralled out of control.

“Hey, Ryan, heads up. You’ve got a visitor,” T.J.'s voice cut through my thoughts, and I looked up, startled. He gave me a pointed look, his lips quirking into an amused smile. I followed his gaze to see a figure making their way towards my desk, and my stomach clenched when I recognised who it was.

Mitch.

He looked almost the same as I remembered from school—tall, broad-shouldered, confident, a smirk always lurking at the corner of his lips. His

dark hair was a little shorter now, his face more rugged, but the arrogance was still there, etched into every step he took. It felt strange, seeing him here, in my office, after all these years.

“Ryan,” Mitch said, his voice carrying that same easy swagger that used to drive me mad back in school. “Long time, no see, huh?”

I forced a smile, standing up and extending my hand. “Mitch. Yeah, it’s been a while.” His grip was firm, too firm as if he was trying to remind me of the old power dynamic that I’d rather forget.

“Heard we’re gonna be working together again,” Mitch said, leaning casually against my desk, his cold blue eyes sweeping over my workspace as if he owned it. “Sophie told me you’re back on my account.”

“Yeah, that’s right. Sophie’s been moved on to a new project,” I said, trying to keep my tone neutral. I could feel T.J.’s eyes on us, his curiosity practically radiating off him, but I ignored it, focusing on Mitch instead. “So, how have you been?”

Mitch shrugged, a lazy grin spreading across his face. “Can’t complain. Business is good, keeping busy, you know how it is. I gotta say, though, I was surprised when I heard you were taking me on again. Thought you’d had enough of me back in the day.”

I chuckled, though it felt forced. “Well, things change, don’t they?”

Mitch’s eyes narrowed slightly, the smirk still playing on his lips. “Yeah, they do. Talking about change, I heard about you and Emmie breaking up.”

I paused, caught off guard by the directness. I shouldn’t have been surprised—Mitch had always had a way of knowing things. He’d known Emmie and I since our younger days and we had plenty of mutual friends, so it was no great wonder that the news had reached him. “Yeah, we did. But it was just a bit of a hiccup, you know? But we’re back together now, stronger than ever.”

“Is that right?” Mitch said, his tone almost mocking, though there was something else beneath it—something that felt off. “Glad to hear it. You know, I always thought you two had something special. Ever since school.”

There was a flicker in his eyes, something that made me uneasy. Was it sarcasm? Jealousy? Or maybe he knew more than he was letting on. I couldn’t tell, and it made my fists bunch.

“Thanks,” I said, keeping my voice steady, even though my pulse had picked up. I hid my balled fists beneath the table so he wouldn’t notice. “We’re in a good place now. Talking about starting a family even.”

Mitch studied me for a moment, his gaze sharp, as if he was trying to see right through me. "Wow. That's fantastic news. Congratulations. It's just... some things change, some don't, you know? People move on, but not everyone can let go."

I frowned, trying to figure out what he meant by that, but Mitch pushed away from the desk before I could respond, clapping me hard—too hard—on the shoulder.

"Congrats again and I hope the baby-making goes well. You'll have to keep me updated on that."

I stared at him for a moment while rubbing my shoulder absently as he stepped away.

"Anyway, I'm looking forward to working with you again, Ryan," he said over his shoulder as he turned to leave. "It should be fun."

"Yeah," I said, not quite sure what else to say. Fun wasn't exactly the word I'd use, but I wasn't about to argue. Mitch left with that same confident stride, and I watched him go, the tension in my chest refusing to ease. Then I let out a breath I hadn't realised I'd been holding, my eyes drifting back to T.J., who was watching me with a raised eyebrow.

"Everything alright?" T.J. asked with a hint of amusement in his voice. "That seemed... intense."

"Yeah," I muttered, sitting back down and rubbing a hand over my face. "It's just... the history between us. You know how it is. Back in school, Mitch and I were never exactly friends. He was always playing the *big man*, always trying to push others around. Now he's just the same in business, demanding, arrogant. You know the type."

T.J. nodded, then opened his mouth like he was about to say something more, but then seemed to think better of it, giving me a pat on the shoulder instead. "Well, if you need anything, just shout."

"Thanks," I said, watching my dark-skinned nerdy friend as he walked away. I turned back to my computer, trying to refocus, but my thoughts were still tangled, the encounter with Mitch only adding to the mess in my head.

There was something about the way he'd mentioned Emmie and I breaking up. I couldn't put my finger on it, but... was Mitch the man in the video? The thought made my stomach churn. Of course it wasn't Mitch. That would be... a nightmare. Emmie wouldn't do that to me. But the way he'd looked at me, the things he'd said—it was all just cryptic enough to

make me wonder. Was he trying to mess with me, or was there something more behind it?

I needed to talk to someone about all of this. About Emmie, the video, the messages. I couldn't keep it all inside anymore, not without it driving me mad. Luke—maybe he'd understand. Maybe he'd have some advice, some way to help me make sense of everything.

I picked up my phone, sending Luke a quick text:

Fancy a pint after work? Could use a chat.

His reply came almost immediately:

Always. See you at our usual watering hole.

I texted a quick reply to say 'Sure' and slipped my phone back into my pocket, a sense of relief washing over me. Maybe tonight, I'd finally start to figure some of this out.

The Red Lion was busy as usual. The regular clientele filled the bar with the soft mumble of chatter as I entered, a couple of them looking my way, then returning back to their companions once they recognised me as a local. The warm glow of the overhead lights reflected off the wooden bar, giving the pub a cosy, comfortable atmosphere and. I found Luke already sitting in our usual booth, a pint of lager in front of him. He raised his glass when he saw me, nodding towards the bar where mine was waiting.

“You look like you’ve had a rough day,” Luke said as I slid into the seat opposite him, his eyes narrowing slightly with concern. “Everything alright?”

I gave him a weak smile, reaching for the pint and taking a long sip. The cold liquid was refreshing, but it did little to ease the tension that had settled in my chest. “You could say that,” I muttered, setting the glass down and looking at Luke. I knew I needed to talk about it, but now that I was here, the words seemed harder to find.

Luke tilted his head, studying me for a moment before leaning forward. “Come on, Ryan. There's obviously something wrong for you to fancy a pint and a chat on a Tuesday night. You know you can tell me anything. Is it about Emmie? Did you guys have a fight or something?”

I nodded, swallowing hard. “Yeah. Yeah, it’s about Emmie,” I said, my voice barely above a whisper. “But not a fight. Something happened.

Something I can't quite figure out."

Luke's expression softened, his voice gentle. "Like what?"

I took another sip of my pint, my fingers tapping against the glass as I tried to gather my thoughts. "Do you remember when you asked me about Emmie? If we were doing okay?"

"Yeah. You said you were back together, stronger than ever," Luke replied.

I gave a hollow laugh. "I didn't want to tell you before. It's a bit... embarrassing."

"I'm your best friend," Luke sighed, taking a long pull of his beer. "There's no need to be embarrassed with me. Just spit it out, whatever it is."

He was right. It would do me good to get things off my chest and I had nothing to be ashamed of with Luke. We knew each other well and told each other almost everything.

"I thought we were okay," I replied quietly. "I mean... We are okay but... I found something... last week... before we met up with you and Natasha."

"You found what?"

"Emmie was getting ready," I explained, feeling my cheeks heat up. "She got a jacket out of the wardrobe that she hadn't worn in forever and two condom wrappers fell out of the pocket. And not ones she'd used with me."

Luke blinked, his brows furrowing. "So... If they're not ones you used... Shit. What did she say?"

"She said they were from during our break," I said, the words bitter on my tongue. "When I asked her to explain, she told me about this guy she slept with. 'Shaun,' she said his name was. Just a one-off, nothing serious."

Luke nodded slowly, his expression thoughtful. "But it was from when you were single, so that's cool, right?"

I looked away, my gaze falling to the table. "It was a bit of a shock but it's not just that." I hesitated, my chest tightening. I wasn't sure how much I should share, but Luke had always been there for me. If anyone could help me make sense of this, it was him. "I got an email while I was at work yesterday," I finally said, my voice barely audible. "From someone who says they know all about Emmie."

"Huh?" Luke's eyes widened. "That's weird timing. You just found out then someone gets in touch? Who was it? The guy she slept with?"

"I don't know." I shrugged. "The email was anonymous but there's more. Attached to the email was a video. A video of Emmie and the guy."

Luke sat back in his seat, clearly taken aback. "A video? As in a sex video?"

I nodded, my throat too dry to speak.

"Bloody hell, Ryan. Are you serious?"

I took a large drink, necking half the beer in one. "Yeah. It's her, Luke. She's... on her knees, with this guy. I don't know who he is, but..." My voice cracked, and I took a deep breath, trying to steady myself. "I don't know what to do. I've watched it a few times, and I'm—I'm ashamed to say it, but it's like I can't stop watching it. It's completely fucked my head up, seeing her with another guy."

Luke leaned in, his eyes narrowing. "And you don't know who the guy is in the video? Is it the person who sent it or is this someone trying to blackmail you and Emmie?"

"No," I said, shaking my head. "I don't think so. They just said they'd be touch again soon. I have no idea if it's the same person in the video. There was no name, no nothing. Just the video, and then a message saying they'd be in touch."

"Wow," Luke muttered, running a hand through his sandy hair. "This is serious. You've got to tell Emmie."

"I can't," I said, my voice sharper than intended. I looked around the pub but no one was paying attention to us. "Not yet. I need to know more. What she did. Who the guy is. Who's behind this. If I tell her now, she'll... I don't know, she'll make it all disappear. Emmie's good at that sort of thing. No, I need to know the truth, Luke. I can't just let it go."

My best friend studied me for a moment, then leaned back in his seat again, letting out a slow breath. He waved over to Max who was working the bar, signalling for him to bring two more beers over.

"Alright. Alright, I get it," he murmured softly. "But you're walking a dangerous line here, Ryan. You're playing with fire. I'd just get it all out in the open. See what Emmie has to say. If there's a video out there of her—a sex video—she should know."

I nodded, my fingers tightening around my glass. "I know. I'll tell her, just not yet. I want to figure this thing out. See what this person wants."

Luke was quiet for a moment, then a sly grin spread across his face. "You know, I could probably help you figure this out. If you show me the video, I might recognise the guy."

I stared at him, my heart pounding. "No, Luke. I'm not showing you the video. It's... it's personal. I can't do that."

"Come on," Luke said, his grin widening. "Just a peek. I mean, I showed you Natasha's tits last week. You know I won't say anything."

"No," I said firmly, even though I knew he was just fooling around. "I'm not showing you, Luke. I just... I need your advice, not..." I trailed off, shaking my head.

Luke sighed, holding up his hands in surrender. "Okay, fine. You can at least tell me what's in the video though. Give your best friend something to think about."

I tried to glare at him but his grin was too infectious to resist. I smiled back. Telling him couldn't hurt.

"She's naked," I started, feeling my cheeks redden again. "She's on her knees, sucking his cock. Then just as they're about to have sex, the video stops."

"Fuck." Luke blinked. "I'm sorry for saying this, but that sounds really fucking hot."

I couldn't help but laugh at him. Somehow, Luke's inappropriate behaviour always made me smile.

"I'm still not showing you," I told him, preempting him before he asked again.

Luke held his hands up innocently again. "I'm just saying if you change your mind..." He gave me a wink, then finished off his pint as I did the same.

As I placed my empty glass on the table, I caught sight of Max, the barman, heading our way, his brows furrowed slightly. He made his way over, putting two fresh glasses of lager in front of us before taking payment from Luke. "Everything alright with you guys?" he asked, his eyes lingering on me.

"Yeah, we're good, Max," Luke said, flashing him a smile. "Just a bit of a heart-to-heart, you know how it is."

Max nodded slowly, his eyes flicking to me. "If you say so. Are you sure you're alright, Ryan? You look a bit... off."

I forced a smile, shrugging. "I'm fine. Just a lot on my mind, that's all."

Max hesitated, then nodded. "Alright. Just let me know if you need anything, yeah?" Why was he acting so weird? He turned to head back to the bar, but I stopped him, a sudden curiosity getting the better of me.

"Hey, Max," I called, and he turned back, raising an eyebrow. "Do you know how to attach a video to an email?"

"What?" Max's face was a mask of confusion and he glanced at Luke, who was watching me with a bemused expression. "I'm not very technical, you know that, What do you even mean? Video? Email?"

"Don't worry about it," I told him, waving the question away and then I watched Max head back to the bar, his shoulders visibly relaxing as he walked away. I couldn't help but feel a twinge of guilt. Of course, it wasn't him. The guy had looked genuinely puzzled when I'd asked him about the email. What was I thinking? Max was the sort of person who minded his own business; he wouldn't have the inclination, let alone the technical skills, to send me a video like that. I shook my head, mentally chiding myself for even letting the thought cross my mind. I needed to be less paranoid, or I'd lose my mind.

Luke, sensing the shift in my mood, leaned back and gave me a measured look. "So, what's the plan? You going to confront Emmie, or just wait it out?"

I sighed, staring down at the frothy top of my beer. "I'm going to wait," I said. "Wait for whoever it is to email me again. See what they want. Maybe I'll get a clue from that. Right now, it's all I can do. I don't want to start pointing fingers without knowing for sure."

Luke nodded, giving me a half-smile. "Probably the smart move. But, you know, dirty videos aren't anything to be ashamed of. Nat and I have made a few ourselves. You want to see one? I could show you, if you're willing to show me the one of Emmie. Fair trade, right?" He winked, his grin widening.

I laughed, shaking my head, though the idea made my heart race in a strange way. "You're incorrigible, Luke. And no, I'm not showing you the video. I appreciate the offer, but some things are meant to stay private."

Luke shrugged, still grinning. "Fair enough, mate. The offer stands, though."

"And I'm quite sure Natasha wouldn't appreciate you showing me—" I started to say then stopped as a voice rang out from behind me.

"Natasha wouldn't what?"

I glanced up, my eyes widening slightly as Natasha leaned over my shoulder, picking up my pint and taking a cheeky drink from it. She looked

stunning, her dark hair swept back, her figure-hugging dress turning a few heads behind her.

"Well, well," she said, not waiting for me to reply, her voice honey-sweet as she put my glass down, licking the foam from her red-painted lips. "What have we here? You boys having fun without me?"

Luke grinned, sliding out of the booth to stand beside her. "Just a couple of pints and a heart-to-heart. Ryan wanted to talk about work stuff. Nothing too exciting."

Natasha's eyes lingered on me, her smile almost predatory. "Good to see you again, Ryan." She leaned in slightly, her perfume enveloping me, something rich and intoxicating. "How's the lovely Emmie? Have you left her at home tonight?"

I forced a smile, trying to ignore the flutter of discomfort her presence caused. There was something about Natasha that seemed to see straight through me, like she could pick apart my secrets if she wanted to. "She's fine," I said. "Me and Luke were just having some man-to-man time, you know?"

She tilted her head, her eyes narrowing slightly before she looked back at Luke. "Ah, I see. Well, I hate to break up the bromance, but I was hoping to steal my boyfriend away for dinner. We've got reservations, and I'm starving."

Luke glanced at me, an apologetic smile on his face. "Sorry. When you texted me, I completely forgot I'd promised her dinner. It's a fancy place and all that. You'll be alright, yeah?"

I nodded, waving them off. "Of course. Go on, enjoy yourselves. I'll catch you later." Natasha gave me one last lingering look before she took Luke's arm, and they headed for the door, leaving me alone at the booth.

I stared at the empty space where they'd been, a mix of emotions swirling inside me. I took a deep breath, trying to calm the storm. I had to stop being so paranoid—suspecting Max, Mitch, maybe even Natasha. It was starting to eat away at me, making me see threats where there were none. I had to keep a clear head if I wanted to get to the bottom of this.

But something Luke had said stuck with me. The email—it had come just after the condoms fell out of Emmie's jacket. As if whoever sent it knew what had happened. A coincidence, he'd said. The only person I knew of who knew about the condoms—about Emmie's secret being out—was Jen.

But why would Jen have a copy of the video? Why would she email it to me like that? It didn't make any sense.

My phone buzzed in my pocket, and I pulled it out, a small smile tugging at my lips when I saw Emmie's name light up the screen.

What time are you coming home? I'm lonely... and fertile.

I let out a breath, a warmth spreading through me despite the turmoil in my head. I finished my drink, setting the empty glass on the table before standing up. Max caught my eye as I made my way to the door, his gaze following me, an unreadable expression on his face. I gave him a nod, and he returned it, though there was something in his eyes—concern, maybe? Or was I just imagining it?

I pushed the thought aside, stepping out into the cool evening air. Whatever was going on, I'd figure it out. But right now, I had a wife waiting for me at home, and I wasn't about to keep her waiting.

Chapter Three

My 11.00 AM reminder alarm went off on my phone and I tapped the 'dismiss' button and then returned to staring blankly at my screen. I set the reminder to prompt me to get a coffee, take a walk around the building, and stretch my legs. It was easy to lose my sense of time in the morning when I was busy. Sometimes, before I knew it, lunchtime came around and I'd stand and curse, my back stiff from sitting and my legs numb. But today, I didn't get up. Even though the office was busy, I was too distracted to do much, my thoughts were a world away. I should've been replying to client emails, and reviewing proposals, but my mind had its own agenda—circling back to last night with Emmie, to the feel of her, the way she'd pulled me back into her arms as if everything was perfectly right between us.

It had been good to talk to Luke and unburden myself of my doubts and worries, even if it was only temporary. It had been a relief to hear him say that whatever Emmie had done, she'd done when she was free and single. He didn't judge her for doing what she'd done, or see me as any less of a man. I hadn't even realised that was something I was worried about until I talked to him. He'd helped me work through some things, helped focus me.

The image I'd seen on his phone, of Natasha, naked, a preview of his own sex tape, popped into my head unbidden. It had been a shock to see her in the flesh right after I'd seen that, but it had also been good to see it. She was hot, after all—but also it was good to know that Emmie wasn't alone in making a sex tape. It wasn't an uncommon thing. It meant nothing.

And then she'd texted me, a siren call. When I got home, she was waiting—sultry, horny and as she worded it; fertile. She needed me, she told me and for those hours in our bed, there had been no mystery video, no suspicions—just us, tangled together, fucking in the dark.

I remembered how she'd looked at me when I got home—her eyes hungry, her lips already curved into that mischievous smile. She'd practically pounced on me as soon as I walked through the door. Her body had been electric, her hands impatient as they tore at my shirt, pulling me into the bedroom before I could even kick off my shoes.

My mind drifted as I thought about the way she'd kissed me, her fingers knotting in my hair, guiding me down to kiss and suck her nipples—then to the other place that made her moan, beneath her thighs, the soft, smooth flesh of her pussy against my lips. I'd delved my tongue into her, swirled it around her swollen clit, made her squirm beneath me. I was so horny. It wasn't just her body; it was the way she wanted me. The way she was so open about it. The way she took control, the way she demanded every inch of me. And I had given it willingly—again and again until we were both too exhausted to move.

The video had come into my mind at one part—as she turned kneeling in front of me, offering up her pussy for me to fuck her from behind. Once, that had felt so simple, so natural. Now, there was a different edge to it—a tinge of jealousy, possessiveness. The image of her doing this same thing but for another man—the video replaying in my head—it twisted something inside me, made me want her harder, faster, as if somehow that could erase what I had seen, make it mine again.

It had been raw, frantic—a way of trying to stake my claim, to feel like we were still solid. She had no idea what was going on in my head, why I needed her like that. But she had responded—God, she had responded, meeting me thrust for thrust, moaning loudly as I pounded her for all I was worth.

“Hey, Ryan, you alright,?” T.J.'s voice cut through my thoughts, and I blinked, startled. He was standing by my desk, his brow furrowed, looking at me with an amused but concerned expression. “You looked like you were miles away just now.”

I forced a smile, clearing my throat. “Yeah, just... thinking. Got a lot on my mind.”

“Work or personal?” he asked, leaning on the partition, his eyes twinkling as if he expected some juicy gossip.

“Bit of both,” I replied, trying to keep my voice light. “You know how it is.”

T.J. gave me a knowing nod, his dark skin glowing beneath the halogen lights right above him. “Well, try not to daydream too much. Helen’s in a mood today, and if she catches you slacking off, you know she’ll have your head.”

“Yeah, cheers for the heads-up,” I said, offering him a grateful smile as he walked away. I let out a breath, my thoughts still a jumbled mess, my body still thrumming with the memory of Emmie—and the uncertainty of everything else.

I shifted in my chair, the memory making my trousers feel too tight. I let out a shaky breath, trying to focus back on the work in front of me. But it was useless. My thoughts were too fixed on her, by the sex, by the video—and by the nagging questions that had yet to be answered.

Suddenly, a notification pinged on my computer screen, making me jump slightly, just as the reminder alarm had. My heart pounded as I saw it was an email but not a work email. The sender was a random, throwaway email address, just like the last one—the one with the video of Emmie. My pulse quickened, a mix of dread and curiosity knotting my stomach as I double-clicked to open it.

The email contained no message, just an attachment. Another video. My hands were trembling as I clicked on it, a cold sweat breaking out across my forehead. A video window opened, and there she was—Emmie, partially undressed, her blonde wavy hair flowing over her shoulders in the dim light of someone's bedroom—not ours—her eyes half-closed in a mix of pleasure and anticipation. A man—the same one from the previous video?—was there, his hands finishing what they had started, unclasping her bra and tossing it to one side. He seemed to take a moment to enjoy the sight of her large breasts, how they hung, swaying slightly as she shifted on the bed. She smiled at the camera in the soft light cast by the bedside lamp, unashamed of being so exposed. Her hard nipples cast shadows across her unblemished skin.

Then his hands came into view again, sliding her black panties down, exposing her entirely. The camera hovered again, zooming slightly in on her full-frontal nudity, on her perfectly shaved mound and the sexy gap

between her thighs. My breath caught as I watched the stranger's fingers slide over her breasts, his movements deliberate, moving down her flat stomach and across her bare pussy, as if savouring just how soft her skin was everywhere. The camera captured it all.

Emmie gasped as he pushed a finger into her wetness, her body arching slightly, her eyes fluttering shut. She leaned back into his touch. My chest tightened, my throat dry as I watched him—whoever he was—finger her for a few minutes. A mix of anger, jealousy, and something darker welled up inside me. She seemed so lost in the moment, so completely given over to him.

Emmie reached down, a hand on his wrist, and for a moment, I thought she was telling him to stop. But no, she was guiding him, helping him set a pace. My gut tightened. A moment later, he pulled back, and she took over pleasuring herself on her own. She spread herself open, showing the pinkness of her holes, her fingers moving over her clit, her hazel eyes meeting the camera's lens. She stared straight ahead, and I could see her mouth moving, forming words I couldn't hear. There was no audio—just the silent, tantalizing image of her pleasuring herself while staring right into the camera as if she were speaking directly to me.

The cameraman stepped back, the view dipping down and I watched as he undid his trousers, letting them fall to the floor, followed by his shorts. Emmie moved forward into view, her expression shifting—a relaxed smile crossing her face. She knelt before him, her hands reaching out to grasp his long, hard, girthy cock, her lips parting as she leaned forward. My heart pounded, my breaths shallow as I realized what was coming next—this was the lead-up to the last video. The moment she took him into her mouth, the screen went black.

A second later, my inbox pinged again—a new message from the same throwaway address. My breaths shuddered as I clicked it open. This time, there was a message:

There is more. You need to know the truth. I will be in contact soon. Be ready to meet if you want to understand.

I tried to reply, my fingers shaking as I typed out a response—*Who are you? What do you want?*—but the email bounced back immediately, the address already deactivated. I stared at the screen, frustration bubbling up inside me. Whoever was doing this, they were playing games, and I was caught right in the middle of it.

I leaned back in my chair, my mind spinning. I was right. There was more video, that much was certain. This wasn't just some random act of cruelty. Someone had edited this video into parts and was sending them to me for a reason. I needed to figure out who it was—and why.

I needed to clear my head. The video, the feelings it stirred in me, the confusion of it all—it was too much to handle sitting at my desk. I closed my email, got up, and decided to take my 11.00 AM walk after all, to try and get some air, some distance.

I made my way to the office toilets, needing to relieve myself but it was hard to pee. My cock was hard, fully erect, painfully so. I managed to empty my bladder but my shaft ached in my hand. What was wrong with me? Why was I so aroused?

Fuck it. I slipped into a stall, locking the door behind me. My cock was still hard in my hand, my thoughts consumed by Emmie, by that damned video and the one I'd received before. My hand trembled, I was so turned on as my fingers wrapped around my length. I closed my eyes, images of Emmie flashing in my mind—her moans, her movements, the way she'd spread her pussy for the camera.

I started stroking myself, slow at first, my breaths coming in shallow gasps. The thrill of it, the risk of jerking off at work only seemed to heighten everything. I bit my lip, my hand moving faster, my mind replaying every second of that video. I was so close, my entire body tensed, ready to let go—

The sound of the bathroom door opening made my eyes fly open, panic seizing me. I froze, my heart pounding in my chest as I heard footsteps, someone moving around outside the cubicle. Even though they couldn't possibly know I was jerking off, I quickly let go, tucking myself back into my trousers, my face burning with shame. I waited, holding my breath until the person left, the door swinging shut behind them. I let out a shaky breath, my body still aching for release, but the moment had passed.

I needed somewhere more private, somewhere I could just let go without the risk of someone walking in. The thought of going back to my desk like this, with my cock still hard and my head still full of Emmie, was unbearable. I left the bathroom, making my way towards the car park, my heart still pounding in my ears.

Once I was outside, I found my car, slipping into the driver's seat and locking the doors behind me. I moved the car to a dark corner of the lot,

away from the windows of the office, away from prying eyes. The car park was devoid of people, everyone else was still inside, focused on their work. I leaned back in my seat, unzipping my trousers again, my cock springing free. I was still so hard, the ache was almost painful now.

I wrapped my hand around myself once more, letting out a soft groan as I started stroking, faster this time, the need for release overwhelming. I closed my eyes, my mind filled with Emmie—her body, her moans, the way she looked when she played with her pussy for her lover, how his fingers had rammed into her, coming out slick with her juices.

I could feel it building, the tension coiling tighter and tighter until I finally let go, a shuddering gasp escaping me as I came, spilling into a tissue I quickly grabbed from the glove compartment.

I sat there for a moment, my breath ragged, my body trembling as the release washed over me. I wiped myself clean, tucking myself back into my trousers, my heart still pounding as I tried to collect myself. But just as I was about to sit up, there was a knock on the window.

I jumped, my head snapping to the side to see Helen, my boss, standing there, her perfectly shaped dark brows raised, her lips pressed into a thin line. I quickly rolled down the window, my face flushing with embarrassment.

“Helen,” I stammered, trying to sound casual, even though my heart felt like it was about to burst out of my chest. “What’s up?”

She looked at me for a moment, her deep brown eyes narrowing slightly. The wind caught in a loose strand of dark hair that had worked its way out of the tight bun atop her head. “Why aren’t you at your desk, Ryan? I’ve been looking for you.”

“Uh, I just needed a break,” I said, forcing a smile. “I just need some fresh air for ten minutes, you know?”

Helen studied me for a moment longer, her gaze dropping to the tissue in my hand before flicking back up to my face. She was in her late forties, much older than me, still attractive though, despite the faint lines at the edges of her tilted eyes. Her expression was unreadable, and I couldn’t tell if she’d seen anything, if she knew what I’d been doing. “Well, when you’re done with your... break, I need you back inside. Sophie has the final handover of the Mitch account to pass to you. Then I thought we’d have a quick meeting to discuss it.”

“Right. Of course,” I said, nodding quickly. “I’ll be right in.”

She gave me one last look before turning and walking away, her heels clicking against the pavement. I watched her go, my stomach churning with a mix of shame and fear. Had she seen me? Did she know? The thought made my skin crawl, but there was nothing I could do about it now.

I sat there for a moment longer, my heart still racing, my body still tingling with a mix of fear and arousal. I needed to pull myself together, needed to get back to my desk and act like everything was normal. But as I watched Helen walk away, that tight smile still playing on her lips, I couldn't shake the feeling that she'd seen me—and if she had, things were about to get a lot more complicated.

I took a deep breath, forcing myself to calm down, to focus. I needed to stay sharp, get my mind back on the videos and figure this out before it all spiralled out of control. Whoever was behind the emails—they weren't done with me yet, they said they'd be in contact again and mentioned meeting up. It seemed like all of this might be coming to a head and so I needed to prepare for that.

But as I stepped out of the car and made my way back to the office, I couldn't help but feel like I was already in way over my head. The game was on, and I was nowhere near ready to play.

Chapter Four

The end of the workday couldn't come soon enough. My mind was still buzzing from the second video I'd received. I wasn't expecting to see the lead-up to the first video—Emmie undressing, the way her body moved, the way she touched herself for the camera. Then, the moment that had burned itself into my brain: Emmie kneeling, taking the man in her mouth, her lips parting in that sensual way that made my cock ache. I could still feel that heat, the arousal that had surged through me when I watched it, even though I knew I shouldn't be feeling that way. It made me feel weird—seeing her like that with someone else, but the strange fascination and turn-on factor were impossible to ignore.

I'd watched the video twice more when I had space around me in the office. The mental image of Emmie wouldn't leave my thoughts all day, clouding everything else, and I found myself with those conflicting feelings of jealousy and desire—even though I'd been reckless enough to jerk off in the car park. Even Helen appearing out of nowhere and catching me right afterwards hadn't dulled my arousal. She hadn't said anything, thank God, but her strange look made it clear she suspected something. I just prayed she hadn't seen anything.

By the time office hours were over, I was desperate to leave. The rest of the afternoon had been uneventful at least, and the meeting with Helen and Sophie had gone smoothly—more smoothly than I'd expected, given what had happened. Sophie completed the handover of the Mitch account back to

me with a couple more files and zero fuss, although her usual flirtatious grin never wavered. She leaned a little too close when she passed the paperwork over, her fingers brushing against mine as she held the folder, her eyes catching mine in that knowing way.

"Good luck with Mitch," she said, her voice carrying just a hint of teasing. "And remember what I said, if you need any help, or if you ever need a break from all this," she gestured vaguely around the office, "You could always come find me. I wouldn't say no to that drink." She left it at that, her eyes lingering on me before she walked away, her hips swaying. It was harmless enough on the surface, but there was always an undertone with Sophie—a hint of something more. She'd tried it on with me once before, back when Emmie and I were on our break, the reason I'd almost asked her out. Part of me wondered if that interest had ever really gone away.

Helen, on the other hand, was her usual cold, businesslike self. She sat behind her desk, her eyes sharp, her words clipped. There was no mention of what had happened in the car park, no indication that she even cared beyond business. I left her office feeling relieved but still on edge, like I'd narrowly avoided a disaster.

By the time I got home, all I wanted was the comfort of seeing Emmie. Just the sound of her voice, the feel of her arms around me—I needed that. The day had left me drained in ways I couldn't quite articulate, and Emmie was the only thing that helped me forget, even for a moment.

But as I stepped into the house, the silence hit me. It was too quiet, and I immediately knew she wasn't there. My shoulders slumped slightly as I headed into the kitchen, and that's when I saw it—a bright yellow sticky note slapped onto the fridge door.

"Hey, gone to the gym, then to Jen's for a coffee. Make yourself something if you're hungry. I'll be back soon. Love, Em."

I sighed, running a hand through my hair. It wasn't that I minded being alone—it gave me time to think, to try and untangle the mess in my head—but part of me had hoped she'd be here, that we could just... be together. No videos, no secrets, just us.

I made myself a quick sandwich and ate it standing at the kitchen counter, my mind still racing. I needed to figure this out, to get to the bottom of who was sending these videos and why. The second email had come with a

message that suggested I'd soon get to meet the sender but I didn't want to wait until then.

My eyes drifted back to the note, focusing on Jen's name. Emmie was going to see Jen after the gym as if everything was normal. But I knew differently now, didn't I? Jen was one of the people who knew. If she was to be believed, she'd been there, met this Shaun. The unmemorable Shaun with his small dick. Emmie had set me up to go to the hairdressers, got her sister to sell me the story of it being a one-off. Then she'd texted her the other night, spoken to her. Was that about me?

I needed to clear my head. After devouring the sandwich, I took a quick shower, hoping it would help me relax. The hot water did little to ease the tension in my muscles, but it felt good to wash away the day, to just stand there under the spray and let everything else fade away for a few minutes.

I stepped out of the shower, wrapping a towel around my waist as I walked into the bedroom. The curtains were open, and as I reached for a clean shirt, movement outside caught my eye. I glanced out the window and froze.

Laura was in her back garden again, a cigarette in her hand, her eyes locked on me. She didn't look away, didn't even try to hide the fact that she was watching. Instead, she smiled, a slow, knowing smile that sent a shiver down my spine.

I turned away quickly, my face heating up as I quickly pulled on my clothes, a T-shirt and sweatpants. But something about the way she'd looked at me—so brazen, so unapologetic, just like last time—it made my jaw clench. I couldn't just let it go.

Once dressed, I headed downstairs and out the back door, crossing the small patch of grass that separated our gardens. Laura was still there, leaning against the fence, her cigarette dangling between her fingers as she watched me approach.

"Hey, Ryan," she said, her voice light, teasing. "A nice hot shower after a long day at work, huh?"

I forced a smile, trying to keep my tone casual. "Yeah, something like that. I thought we should talk. You've been... spending a lot of time out here lately. It's the second time I've seen you looking."

She raised an eyebrow, her lips curling into a smirk. "Then maybe you should shut your curtains from time to time," she said, her eyes glinting

with mischief. She took a drag of her cigarette, blowing the smoke out slowly. "Not that I mind the view."

I frowned, stepping closer. "Laura, have you seen..." My mouth was suddenly dry for some reason. "What *have* you seen?"

Her smile widened, and she tilted her head, her pretty brown eyes studying me. "Why do you ask?" she said, her voice dripping with amusement. "Are you worried I've seen something I shouldn't have?"

I turned and looked up at our bedroom window. I'd left the light on and I had a clear view of most of the room, from perhaps waist-height upwards. "It is our bedroom, Laura. Do I have to spell it out?"

My redhead neighbour took another slow drag of her cigarette, her gaze never leaving mine. There was something about her that was disarming and yet troubling at the same time.

"I'm out here a lot, you know," she said finally, avoiding the question, her voice casual. She gestured vaguely around her garden, the cigarette smoke curling around her fingers. "Mark doesn't let me smoke in the house. Plus, I like it out here—it's quiet. And you know I enjoy gardening. I did a lot of it when you were away. When you were staying at that flat and Emmie was on her own."

She looked at me, her eyes sparkling with something that made my chest tighten. It was there—the implication hanging between us. She knew. She'd seen something. My pulse quickened, and I took a small step closer, lowering my voice. "While Emmie and I were apart? Laura, what exactly did you see?"

She tilted her head, her smile widening. "What do you think I saw, Ryan?" she said, her tone still teasing, but there was something else in her eyes now—something almost predatory.

"I... I don't know," I stammered, my face flushing. "Don't play games. If there's something you want to tell me..." I trailed off, unsure how to finish the sentence without sounding like an idiot.

Laura's smile softened slightly, and she stepped closer, closing the distance between us. She reached out, her fingers brushing against my arm, her touch light, almost comforting. "I think you know. Emmie got her needs met while you two were apart. I saw things. Let's just say... she wasn't exactly lonely."

My heart pounded in my chest, a mix of anger, jealousy, and something else—something that I couldn't quite place. "Who was it?" I asked, my

voice barely above a whisper.

She shook her head, her fingers trailing down my arm before she pulled away, her eyes still locked on mine. "I don't know. Does it matter? She found a way to fill the void you'd left, I guess. And I don't think she would've minded if you'd done the same. You know, when I came to see you at your flat... or when we bumped into each other at the shop."

Her words hung in the air between us, and I swallowed hard, my throat dry again. I remembered the times she mentioned—Laura coming to check on me, her eyes lingering on me a little too long, taking an age to leave the flat, like she was waiting for something. The way she'd brushed her hand against my backside when we stood by the grocery aisle. I remembered the way she'd smiled at me, the way she'd looked at me, asked me to come back to hers.

"Mark wouldn't even mind if he found out," she continued, her voice low, almost a whisper now. "He's pretty open-minded, you know. And you... well, it seems like you missed out on having fun... while Emmie was getting hers."

I swallowed, my mouth suddenly dry. Laura's eyes were dark, her lips curling into a soft smile as she took another step closer, her body almost brushing against mine. Her hand reached up, her fingers grazing the zipper of her hoodie top, slowly pulling it down to reveal the curve of her cleavage. My breath caught in my throat. She wasn't wearing anything beneath it. My eyes were drawn to the inner swell of her breasts, the way they barely hung, firm and round.

"I've always fancied you, Ryan," she whispered, her voice like silk. "We could have some fun. Discreet fun. No one has to know."

I hesitated, my heart pounding in my chest, my body reacting to her closeness, to the sight of her. She was beautiful and seductive, and the offer was tempting—so tempting. My mind flashed back to the videos of Emmie, to the way she'd looked at the camera, rubbing her clit wantonly for her lover. How she'd sucked his cock hungrily, then turned onto all fours to welcome his cock inside her. My jealousy, my desire—it all blurred together, making it hard to think clearly.

Before I could respond, Laura reached out, her fingers brushing against the front of my sweatpants, her touch light but deliberate. I sucked in a breath, my body reacting instantly, my cock hardening beneath her fingers. She smiled, her eyes meeting mine as she slowly slipped her hand inside,

her fingers wrapping around my already-stiff cock, starting to stroke me with a slow, steady rhythm.

I let out a shaky breath, my eyes closing for a moment as I felt her touch, the pleasure mixing with the guilt, the confusion. This was wrong—I knew it was wrong. But in that moment, with everything else spinning out of control, it felt good. It felt like a release.

"There we go," Laura purred softly, teasing my sweatpants down far enough that she could look at my erection. "Not bad. And already hard for me."

Her top had slipped open further, flashing her breasts fully. They were large, almost as big as Emmie's, full and round and perfectly formed. Her nipples were hard, erect in the cool night air.

"Why don't we take this inside?" she murmured, her breath warm on my neck as she wanked me off faster while planting a light kiss on my collarbone, making me shudder with arousal. I let my hand explore beneath the hoodie, reaching up and cupping her breast, feeling the heat of her skin against my palm and she responded by sighing into my ear. I closed my eyes again at the sensation of her hand working me expertly.

But my phone buzzed in my pocket, and I flinched, my eyes snapping open. Laura's hand stilled, her eyes narrowing slightly as I pulled my phone out, glancing at the screen. It was Emmie.

Hey, babe. Just leaving Jen's now. Are you home? I'll be there in ten minutes.

Before I could reply, another came through:

Have you eaten yet? I was thinking we could order a takeaway.

Her words snapped me back to reality, the guilt crashing over me like a wave. I pulled away from Laura, my heart pounding, my breath coming in shallow gasps. "I... I have to go," I muttered, my voice hoarse. "Emmie's on her way home from her sister's."

Laura's eyes flashed with something—disappointment, frustration—but she quickly masked it, her smile returning. "Sure, Ryan," she said, her voice smooth, her hand slipping out of my sweatpants, leaving me aching, wanting more. "Another time, maybe."

I nodded, not trusting myself to speak as I turned and walked away, my heart pounding in my chest. I could feel her eyes on me as I crossed the garden.

"Her sister came here a lot while you were living at the flat." Laura's words followed me as I headed back towards my house, my mind a jumbled mess of emotions—guilt, arousal, confusion. "Once, she brought a guy too. It's interesting what you see when people don't close their curtains."

I stopped right in front of my back door, turning to look at her. "So... there was more than one time?"

"Emmie had a few visitors, yes." She took one last pull on her cigarette, throwing the glowing butt to the floor and extinguishing it with her foot. "Maybe you should call around when Emmie's not around. I'll tell you all about it."

I nodded, then turned to go back into the house but paused again.

"Are you sending me emails?" I asked quietly, but loud enough for her to hear. When there was no reply, I looked over my shoulder but the garden was empty. The soft click of her back door closing told me she'd already gone back indoors.

When I stepped inside the house, I leaned against the door for a moment, letting out a shaky breath. What the hell was I doing? I'd almost let her seduce me. I'd felt her breast. She'd jerked me off. This wasn't me—this wasn't who I was. But at least now I knew more. Emmie had been with more than one man. Somehow, I'd known. She'd never said she'd only been with Shaun—just that it was a one-off with him. How many men had she been with? And who? I needed to know. It was the only way to get control of my life again. I couldn't let the videos, the messages, the secrets drive me to do things I'd regret.

Emmie was on her way home. She'd be here any moment. Did I ask her directly? Or did I take more time to figure out the truth on my own? If so, I knew where to start now... with my voyeuristic neighbour, Laura.

There was only one problem. Could I trust myself with her?

Chapter Five

I was sitting on the sofa, nursing a cup of coffee, pretending to watch some mindless TV show when I heard the door open. I had to act like I hadn't just been outside, like I hadn't been talking to Laura—flirting with her, nearly doing something stupid. The warmth of the coffee mug in my hands was comforting, and I tried to look as casual as possible as Emmie walked in, her gym bag slung over her shoulder.

"Hey," she said, her voice tired but cheerful, her eyes lighting up when she saw me. She set her bag down by the door and walked over, leaning down to press a quick kiss to my lips.

"Hey yourself," I said, forcing a smile. "How was the gym?"

She straightened up, then sank onto the sofa beside me with a soft groan. She winced as she shifted, her hand reaching back to rub at her lower back.

"Ugh, I think I overdid it today. My back is killing me."

I frowned, my brow furrowing in concern. "You okay? You should take it easy."

"Yeah, just a bit stiff," she said, giving me a reassuring smile. "Craig pushed me a bit today. Maybe too much." She laughed softly, shaking her head. "I should've told him to go easier on me."

I nodded, keeping my expression neutral even though something about her tone made me pause. Craig. She'd mentioned him before—her personal trainer. Could he be... No. I was getting paranoid now. I couldn't allow myself to start suspecting every man in her life. I pushed the thought aside,

not wanting to dwell on it, not right now. "You need to slow down or you'll end up injuring yourself and having to take time off."

She smiled, nodding. "Yeah, you're probably right. I'll just do some light stuff next time." She paused, then glanced at me, her eyes softening. "How was work?"

I shrugged, leaning back against the couch. "It was alright. Nothing too exciting." The email with the video and almost being caught wanking by Helen popped into my head uninvited and I tried to keep my face relaxed. "How was Jen? It's been a while since I've seen her."

Emmie's smile flickered, her gaze shifting to the hot coffee in my hands. "She's fine. We just caught up, you know, usual sister stuff." She looked back at me, her expression guarded, as if she could sense there was more behind my question.

"That's good," I said, nodding. I didn't push it. Not yet. We sat in silence for a moment, the only sound the soft chatter of the television in the background. "Well, if you're a bit sore, maybe we can just relax tonight. Take it easy. Order that takeaway you mentioned."

She smiled, leaning into me and resting her head against my shoulder. "That sounds perfect."

We ordered pizza, something quick and easy, and spent the rest of the evening on the sofa, eating and talking about nothing in particular. It felt normal—comfortable—and for a while, I managed to forget the questions, the doubts, the video and everything that Laura had hinted at earlier.

But later, when we were in bed, curiosity got the better of me. Emmie was lying beside me, her head resting on my chest, her fingers tracing idle patterns across my skin. The room was dim, the only light coming from the lamp on the nightstand, casting a soft glow across the room. I could feel the tension building inside me, the questions bubbling to the surface. I knew I needed to ask—to at least try to get some answers or I wouldn't sleep. I turned to Emmie, my heart pounding in my chest.

"Em," I began, my voice hesitant. "I've been thinking... about, you know, when we were on our break."

Her eyes flicked to mine, a slight tension appearing in her shoulders. "What about it?"

I swallowed, trying to find the right words. "I know you told me not to talk about it but... I want to explain. I was insecure at first, about you going with another guy. But now, I don't know, I guess I'm just... curious." I gave

her a small smile, trying to keep my tone light. "Like, I can't help but wonder about it. It's not jealousy, and it's not that I'm angry about it, I swear. It's more like... I don't know. It's weird to think of you with someone else. I was just wondering if we could have an adult conversation about it."

"But why?" Emmie said softly, reluctance in her voice. "Why would you even want to know?"

"I don't know... It's just kind of... naughty, I guess." My throat was tight but admitting this was the only way I could think of to get her to open up. "Maybe it even turns me on a little. Maybe. Only maybe. I don't want you to think I'm weird or anything."

Emmie's eyes widened slightly, a blush creeping up her cheeks. She looked away for a moment, her eyes avoiding mine, her lips curving into a small, almost shy smile. "Really?"

I nodded, my heart pounding. "Yeah. I mean, I've found myself thinking about it a lot, you know? It's even distracting me at work. I just... I guess I want to know what it was like. With him. Shaun, right? Maybe if I knew more about it, the curiosity would go away."

She bit her lip, her eyes meeting mine, and for a moment, I saw something flicker there—something like excitement. She shuffled closer in bed, turning slightly towards me. "Well... what do you want to know?"

I took a deep breath, my gaze locking onto hers. "Everything," I said, my voice barely above a whisper. "What you did with him. How it felt. All of it."

Emmie hesitated momentarily, then a slow smile spread across her lips. "Alright," she said, her voice softening, taking on a teasing edge. "If you really want to know... I mean, it was just a one-time thing. We met at that bar, remember? And, well, we got drunk. I'd been missing you, and I just wanted to feel... wanted." She paused, her gaze dropping for a moment before she looked back up at me. "He was nice, though. He wasn't pushy. He let me lead."

I swallowed, feeling a strange mix of emotions swirling inside me. "And... what did you do?"

She laughed softly, her eyes glinting with mischief. "You really want all the details?"

I nodded, my breath catching in my throat. "Yeah. I do."

Emmie shifted against me, her hand resting on my thigh. "We went back to his place," she said, her voice dropping to a whisper. "He kissed me, and

I let him undress me. And then... I got on my knees for him." She watched my reaction, her eyes darkening with arousal. "I took him in my mouth, just like I do with you. Then we did it... you know, had sex."

A shiver ran down my spine, my body responding to her words. "Did you like it?" I asked, my voice strained. "Did he make you cum?"

Emmie smiled, her fingers brushing against the inside of my thigh. "Yeah," she whispered. "I came with him. Even though..."

"Jen said he was small," I found myself filling in the gaps when she went quiet. If this was the guy in the video, he certainly wasn't small. That was a lie. But I said it anyway, interested in how she'd react. "I couldn't help but ask Jen about it when she was cutting my hair. She said the guy she went with was unmemorable and she thought Shaun was too."

"Did she?" Emmie nodded, shifting uncomfortably next to me. "Well... yes, he was, I guess. It's just that he was someone new. Someone different, so that was exciting – at the time."

I swallowed hard, my gaze locked on her. "Do you ever think about it still? About him?"

She hesitated, then nodded, her lips curving into a teasing smile. "Sometimes. How can I not? He was the first guy I'd slept with in such a long time, apart from you."

"The *first* guy?" I asked, probing gently on her choice of words. "Was he really the only one, Emmie? I wouldn't be angry if there were others. I'd rather you be honest with me than lie to protect my feelings or something."

"I thought you wanted to know about Shaun?" she replied, after a long moment. "Can we take this one step at a time?"

I didn't want to push too far, too fast. I was making progress and didn't want to ruin it. I took her reply to mean that yes, there were others, just as Laura had hinted. "So, you *do* think about it? When we're together? When we're having sex?"

"Ryan, stop." Emmie's hand found mine beneath the covers, squeezing it gently. Then she sighed. "No. I don't think about it very often. I just remember it occasionally, when I'm on my own."

"When you're...on your own?" I asked, remembering how I caught her the other day. "As in... masturbating?"

Emmie's eyes widened, her cheeks flushing as she looked away for a moment, then back at me. "For fuck's sake, Ryan... I don't know... Maybe," she said, her voice barely above a whisper. Her hand moved higher

on my thigh, her fingers brushing against my growing hardness. "Do you want me to show you?"

"Show me what?"

"Me... touching myself," she purred softly.

I knew she was probably trying to deflect, to close the conversation down but I nodded anyway, my heart pounding. "Yeah. I want to see you cum."

She shifted, pushing the covers away, her hand sliding under the waistband of her pyjama shorts, her eyes locked on mine as she began to touch herself. I watched, my breath coming in shallow gasps as her fingers moved, her lips parting in a soft moan.

"I want to see more," I whispered, lifting her pyjama top to expose her breasts. Emmie responded by taking the top off and sliding down her shorts so I could see her fingers working their magic. Her other hand clutched one of her breasts, squeezing it hard as she began to rub herself. She looked so hot, her eyes lidded, her back arching slightly as she enjoyed the sensation.

I took out my cock, stroking my hard-on while watching her bring herself close to the edge, her fingers delving into her pussy before returning to her clit, using her wetness as lube on her swollen clit.

"God, you look so fucking sexy," I groaned, my voice rough as I jerked off faster. "Did you do this for him?"

Emmie looked at me, her eyes searching mine, her fingers still resting against her clit. She seemed hesitant, but then, with a deep breath, she nodded. "I... might have," she whispered, her fingers returning to the wetness between her legs. Her eyes fluttered closed as she focused on herself again, her hips moving against her hand. I could hear her breath coming in soft gasps, and it only made my own arousal grow.

I continued to stroke my cock, my gaze fixed on her as she worked herself, her moans growing louder, filling the room. I could see the flush spreading across her chest, her nipples hard, her back arching as she grew closer. It was a sight that I knew would be burned into my mind forever. She was beautiful, completely lost in the moment, and I felt an aching need to touch her, to feel her against me.

"Oh, fuck..." she gasped, her body tensing, her hips jerking slightly. Her fingers moved faster, pressing harder against her clit, and I could feel the tension in the air, the way she was teetering on the edge. I was lost in it too, my own strokes growing more frantic as I watched her face, her mouth parted, her breath catching.

And then, with a loud, shuddering moan, she came. Her body shook, her hips bucking as her fingers circled her clit, drawing out her orgasm. I watched her, my breath catching in my throat as I felt my cock twitch in my hand. I had to let go or I'd cum. She looked so fucking sexy like this, completely lost in pleasure.

When her breathing finally slowed, she opened her eyes, looking at me with a small, satisfied smile. Her hand moved to my cock, her fingers curling around my shaft, taking over. I groaned at her touch, her hand slick with her own wetness as she stroked me, her grip firm but gentle. I could feel my body responding, my hips lifting slightly as I felt myself getting closer.

"You're so fucking hot," I groaned, my voice rough. I could feel the tension building in my stomach, my whole body tightening as her hand moved faster, her thumb brushing over the tip, wiping away the precum that was oozing out after almost cumming moments before. I watched her wank me, and then her eyes locked on mine, her smile turning a little wicked as she worked my cock.

"Cum for me," she whispered, her voice low and filled with desire. And that was all it took. My body tensed, my breath catching as I felt the release wash over me, my cum spilling across my stomach as her hand moved, drawing out every last drop.

I collapsed back against the pillows, my breath ragged, my chest heaving. Emmie looked at me, her expression softening as she let go of me, her hand resting on my thigh again, covered in warm, sticky cum. I could see the uncertainty in her eyes, the way she was suddenly unsure, as if the reality of what she'd just told me was starting to sink in.

"That was a waste of good cum," I chuckled and Emmie laughed too, the tension in the room broken by the joke.

"It is," she said, wiping her hand further on my thigh. "I should have got on top, but my back is still a little painful."

"It's okay," I replied softly. I hesitated for a moment, then decided to press my luck. "Where did he cum? Shaun. Did he cum inside you? In the condoms?" I asked, my voice barely audible. It was a strange, almost surreal question to ask, but I needed to know. I needed to understand what had happened, to piece it all together in my mind.

Emmie glanced at me, her expression guarded. She nodded slowly, her eyes dropping to my chest. "Yeah," she said softly. "He did. In me but in the

condoms. He used both of them."

I nodded, absorbing her answer, my gaze drifting away for a moment. What Laura had said still troubled me. "Did you ever... bring him or anyone else back here?" The question came out before I could stop it, and I immediately regretted it, the atmosphere in the room thickening again as the words hung between us.

Emmie looked away, her fingers pulling the covers back over her body, her movements slower, more tentative. "I think that's enough for tonight," she said softly, her voice trembling slightly. "I'm just... feeling a bit embarrassed, and I'm not ready to talk about everything yet."

I nodded, my heart softening at her vulnerability. "That's okay," I said gently, reaching over to brush a strand of hair away from her face. "We don't have to talk about it anymore. I'm just glad you shared what you did."

She gave me a small smile, her eyes meeting mine for a brief moment before she looked away again. I could see the discomfort there, the way she was struggling with everything that had come up tonight. But despite that, I felt a sense of progress. She'd opened up, even if just a little, and I felt closer to understanding what had happened, even if the full truth was still out of reach.

I leaned over, pressing a gentle kiss to her forehead, and she sighed softly, her body relaxing against mine. "Get some sleep," I whispered. "We'll figure it out, one step at a time."

But it seemed to take an age for us to fall asleep. Emmie moved away from me slightly, turning the other way but I could tell from her breathing she wasn't asleep. We both lay there for a while, her head likely as full of conflicting feelings as mine was. Eventually, her breaths softened, deepened and sleep finally claimed me too, but not until I'd replayed the video of her sucking Shaun's cock in my head a dozen times or more. The final thing on my mind as I drifted off was the feeling of Laura's breasts in my hands, and the way she'd jerked me off wantonly in the garden.

Where did I go from here? Should I wait for Emmie to open up and tell me everything in her own time? Would she even tell me? I doubted it. Not unless I somehow forced her hand.

No. Until the emailer came forward again, the only way forward was to see Laura again and find out what she knew. No matter what it might cost.

Chapter Six

It was only just past three, but I found myself glancing at the clock on my computer screen for what felt like the hundredth time that day. It was Friday, two days since the conversation with Emmie, since I'd managed to get her to open up—at least a little—about Shaun. She hadn't mentioned anything more since then, and honestly, I wasn't sure if I wanted her to. Every time I thought about it, I found myself tangled up in a mess of emotions—curiosity, jealousy, arousal—and it was exhausting.

But tonight, I had a plan. Emmie was working late; Nate, her boss, had asked her to stay for a meeting after hours. It meant I'd have the house to myself, but more importantly, it meant I'd have a chance to talk to Laura. I'd tried to catch her a few times over the past couple of days, but something always got in the way—she wasn't home, or Emmie was with me. But tonight, things were lining up, and I couldn't help the anticipation that built inside me at the thought of finally finding out what Laura had hinted at before.

The past day or two had been... calmer, I supposed. Emmie's back was still stiff from her gym session, and while she'd been affectionate, she hadn't been particularly intimate. In a way, it was a relief. I wasn't sure if I could handle the closeness right now, not with everything swirling around in my head. Things had been normal, almost too normal—like we were both tiptoeing around the edges of something we couldn't quite face. But

knowing I had a chance to find out more tonight, to get some answers from Laura, had kept me going.

A notification pinged on my phone, pulling me out of my thoughts. I glanced down at the screen to see a text from Luke.

Hey, need to see you after work. Got something to show you. Can you meet me at the Red Lion? Won't take long.

I frowned, my fingers hovering over the keyboard for a moment before I typed out a reply.

Sure, but it'll have to be quick. I've got plans tonight.

Luke's reply was almost immediate.

No worries. I'm taking Natasha to dinner, meeting her parents. Just need five minutes of your time before that.

I stared at his message for a moment, a smile tugging at the corners of my lips. Meeting the parents, huh? That was a big step, especially for Luke. He wasn't the type to rush into things, not usually. I shot him a quick reply to say I'd be there before sliding my phone back into my pocket, amusement bubbling up inside me. Whatever he had to show me must be important if he was fitting it in before dinner with Natasha's parents.

The minute hand seemed to barely move as the clock slowly ticked toward five o'clock. Each second felt elongated, the anticipation of the evening making time crawl. I tapped my pen against the edge of my desk, my eyes flickering back and forth between the document open on my screen and the clock face on the wall. Four-fifty-eight. Four-fifty-nine. Finally, the minute hand made its last journey to the top, and the little hand clicked firmly into place. Five o'clock.

I wasted no time. I saved my work, shut down my computer, and grabbed my jacket off the back of my chair. The office had already begun emptying out, everyone keen to start their weekends. I had my own plans for the evening, a quiet sense of determination building in my chest. Tonight was the night I'd finally get to speak to Laura without any distractions, without anyone or anything getting in the way.

I was halfway to the lift when I heard my name. "Ryan! Wait up!"

I closed my eyes for a moment, exhaling heavily. Not now, I thought. Not today. I turned to see Sophie making her way towards me, her heels clicking against the tiled floor, her burgundy-dyed hair spilling over her shoulders in perfectly styled waves on one side, the other side partially shaved as seemed to be the fashion.

"Hey," I said, forcing a smile as she approached. "What's up?"

"Just wanted to catch you before you left." Sophie's black-outlined eyes locked onto mine in that mischievous way she always had. She stepped closer, lowering her voice slightly. "How's it going with Mitch's account? Everything okay?"

I nodded, keeping my expression neutral. "Yeah, it's going fine. He called in to the office, set up a meeting for next week. Everything seems pretty straightforward so far. Thanks for the files. They've come in useful."

"No problem." Sophie took another step closer, her voice softening. "You know, if you need any help with anything, I'm always here. I'm still the one who knows Mitch best, after all." There was a hint of something in her voice, an underlying implication that made me tense. Her eyes flicked down to my mouth, then back up to meet my gaze. "It's a shame we can't manage the account together. You and I would make a good team, Ryan."

I swallowed, shifting my weight uneasily. "Yeah, I appreciate it, Soph. But I think I've got it under control."

Sophie didn't seem deterred. She smiled again, her light brown eyes glinting with that same dark intensity. "Of course, you have. Hey, it's Friday night. We could always... grab a drink after work? Celebrate the end of the week? I know a place. We could talk about him. Mitch. I got to know him pretty well." Her voice was low, conspiratorial. "Maybe too well."

I hesitated, my heart beating a little faster. She was close now, too close. Her rich, musky perfume filled my nostrils, sweet and intoxicating, and I took a small step back, trying to put some space between us. "I... I can't tonight. I've got plans. But thanks."

She pouted slightly, her head tilting to the side. "Plans, huh? With Emmie, I assume?" Her tone carried a hint of something—a challenge, perhaps? "You two still going strong, then?"

"Yeah," I said, nodding, trying to keep my tone even. "We are."

Sophie watched me for a long moment, her gaze scrutinising. Then she smiled, her expression softening. "Alright," she said, her voice losing some of its edge. "But you know, if you did change your mind, it wouldn't have to be anything serious. Nothing for Emmie to worry her pretty head about."

"Listen," I sighed. "I'm flattered, Sophie. You're a good-looking girl. But I'm married."

"I don't want a relationship," she giggled, tilting her head as she put a hand on my arm. Her fingernails were long and painted dark -purple. "I just

want to get to know you better."

"But we're work colleagues. Things could be misinterpreted."

The shiny stud in her nose glittered in the light as Sophie shook her head, then she undid the top button of her shirt, the olive skin of her cleavage slipping into view. I briefly wondered about her nipple piercings again. "We could have a lot of fun, Ryan. Emmie wouldn't need to know. In fact, there something I—"

Before she could finish whatever she was about to say next, a sharp voice cut through the air. "Ryan. Sophie. Everything alright here?"

I turned to see Helen standing a few feet away, her dark eyes cold as she looked between the two of us. She wasn't smiling, her expression unreadable, and I felt my stomach lurch as I remembered almost being caught wanking off.

"Yeah, everything's fine," I said quickly, giving Helen a polite nod. "Just on my way out. Sophie was checking in on the Mitch account and how I'm getting on."

Helen's eyes shifted to Sophie, who took a step back, her smile faltering. "Good," Helen said, her tone clipped. "Don't let me keep you. And, Sophie, I think you should get going as well."

Sophie hesitated for a moment, then nodded, her gaze turning to me one last time before she turned and walked away, her impossibly high heels clicking against the floor. Helen watched her go before turning her attention back to me, her eyes narrowing slightly. "Have a good weekend, Ryan," she said, her voice lacking any warmth.

I nodded, offering her a tight smile before turning and heading for the lift, my heart still pounding. I couldn't get out of there fast enough.

The cold air hit me as I stepped out of the building, the tension from the encounter with Sophie and Helen still lingering. I shook it off, pulling my jacket tighter around me as I made my way to my car. I glanced at my watch. I still had time to meet Luke, despite the slight hold-up. It wasn't often he asked for something like this, and his message had sounded important. I could meet him and still get home with enough time to speak to Laura before Emmie came home from her meeting with Nate.

The drive to the Red Lion was quick, the pub's familiar painted sign coming into view as I pulled into the car park. I spotted Luke sitting in our usual spot by the window, a pint in front of him, his phone in his hand. He looked up when he saw me enter, waving me over with a grin.

"About time," he said as I slid into the seat opposite him. "I was starting to think you wouldn't show."

"Yeah, well, I nearly didn't," I said, giving him a wry smile. "My boss held me up as I was leaving. What's so urgent?"

"Do you have time for a drink?"

"A quick one. A coke. I'm driving," I replied, sitting down to wait while he headed to the bar, bringing back my drink and a refilled beer for himself. "So what's so urgent?"

"I'm meeting Nat's parents tonight and tomorrow, I'm taking her to London." Luke's grin widened and he reached into his pocket, pulling out a small velvet box. He placed it on the table between us, his eyes glinting with excitement. "Then," he said, his voice dropping to a conspiratorial whisper. "I'm going to ask her to marry me."

I blinked, my eyes widening as I stared at the box. "Seriously? Luke, that's... wow. That's huge."

He nodded, his grin growing even more as he flipped it open to reveal a beautiful gold ring with a classic diamond that twinkled in the lights above our table. "I know. It's crazy, right? We've only been together a short time, but... I don't know. It just feels right. She's... she's amazing. I'm... in love."

I let out a breath, a smile tugging at my lips. "Wow. I mean, if it feels right, then go for it. I'm happy for you, really. Natasha's... yeah, she's something else." I hesitated for a moment, then added, "You're sure about this, though? I mean, it is pretty fast."

Luke nodded, his expression softening. "I've never been more sure of anything in my life, Ryan. She's the one. I know it sounds cheesy as hell, but I just... I can't imagine my life without her."

I chuckled, shaking my head. "Well, then, I guess congratulations are in order."

Just then, Max walked by, stopping when he saw the box in Luke's hand. "Are you proposing?" he asked, a twinkle in his deep-set eyes. "I think Ryan's already married, right?"

"Yes but not to Ryan, you idiot," my best friend laughed. "I'm taking Natasha to London tomorrow for the weekend. And while we're there, I'm going to pop the question."

"Congratulations!" The landlord of the Red Lion clamped a hand on Luke's shoulder, squeezing it firmly, smiling happily. "I hope it goes well."

Luke nodded his appreciation. "Thanks, mate. I'll take that."

As Max walked away, I picked up my glass, clinking it against Luke's beer. "I'm sure she'll say yes," I reassured him. "She'd be a fool to say no to my best friend."

"Cheers," he said, clinking our drinks for a second time. "And listen, I know you've got plans tonight, so I appreciate you coming by. I just wanted to share the news with you before anyone else."

I nodded, taking a sip of my beer. "Of course, Luke. I'm glad you did."

We sat in silence for a moment, the pub's usual noise filling the space around us. I couldn't help but feel a strange mix of emotions. I was genuinely happy for Luke, but there was something about Natasha that still bugged me. That feeling of familiarity, like I knew her from somewhere but couldn't quite place it. It was frustrating, gnawing at the back of my mind.

As if on cue, the door to the pub opened, and I looked up to see Natasha walking in. She spotted us immediately, her face lighting up with a smile as she made her way over. She looked immaculate, as always, her long, straight dark hair glossy in the dim light, her make-up styled perfectly. Luke stood, pulling her into a hug, and I couldn't help but notice the way her eyes drifted to me over his shoulder, a hint of something in her gaze that I couldn't quite read.

"Hey, Ryan," she said as she pulled away from Luke, her smile widening. "Fancy seeing you here."

I gave her a polite smile, nodding. "Yeah, Luke roped me into it. He wanted to tell me he's meeting your parents tonight. That's a big deal, right?"

Natasha's eyes flicked to Luke, who had deftly slipped the ring back in his pocket. "Oh, did he now?" She looked back at me, her gaze lingering for a moment before she added, "It's not a big deal. He's got to meet them sometime if he's at all serious about me."

I shook my head, chuckling. "Meeting parents is always a big deal, trust me."

Luke beamed, his arm slipping around Natasha's waist. "Alright, you two, I've got to hit the bar to get my beautiful girlfriend a drink. Be right back." He gave her a quick kiss on the cheek before heading towards the bar, leaving Natasha and me alone.

She turned, her light green eyes locking onto mine, a hint of something playful in her gaze. "So, you didn't answer. Is he serious about me?" she asked, her voice low enough that only I could hear.

I hesitated for a moment, then smiled. "He is. I think he's more into you than he's ever been about any girl," I said, my tone light. "And I think you already know that."

Natasha's smile widened, and she took a step closer, her gaze never leaving mine. "You know, Luke talks about you a lot," she said, her voice softening. "He thinks the world of you. Says you're one of the best guys he knows."

I felt my face heat up slightly, and I shrugged. "Well, the feeling's mutual. He's a good friend. My best friend."

She nodded, her eyes studying me for a moment. That feeling of familiarity suddenly came back. I had the beginnings of a vision... of where I'd seen her but as soon as it started to form in my mind, it slipped away again when she spoke.

"I know you and Luke go way back, and I just... I want you to know that I'm not trying to come between that."

I frowned slightly, caught off guard by her words. "I never thought you were," I said slowly. "Why would you think that?"

Natasha hesitated, then gave a small shrug. That sense of familiarity came again but before I could focus on it, she smiled, her vivid green eyes lowering for a moment. "I don't know. I guess I just get the feeling sometimes that... maybe you're not sure about me. Like maybe you don't trust me."

"Huh?" I gazed at her, feeling bad suddenly. I hadn't meant for my unease around her to upset her. "I'm sorry. I didn't mean to—"

"It's fine." She took my hand in hers. It was warm and yet, for some reason, I shivered slightly. She really was beautiful and the image of the nudes that Luke had shown me floated in my head for a moment. I felt my cheeks heat up as I pictured those small, perfectly formed breasts that were hidden beneath her top. "How is Emmie? Have you got her pregnant yet?"

"We've only just started trying," I chuckled. "But I'm giving it my best shot."

"I bet you are." Natasha's eyes bored into mine. What was she hiding? "If I was a guy, I'd be filling her pussy up every night. I bet she's secretly a very dirty girl for daddy in bed, isn't she?"

I opened my mouth to respond, but before I could say anything to the unexpected turn in the conversation, Luke returned, a glass of white wine in his hand and yet another beer. "Here we go," he said, setting them down on

the table. "Wine for Natasha, beer for me. Dutch courage for meeting your family. What did I miss?"

Natasha smiled, shaking her head. "Nothing important," she said, her eyes glancing at mine for a brief moment before she looked back at Luke. "Just getting to know your best friend a bit better."

Luke grinned, oblivious to the tension that had settled between Natasha and me. "Good. I want you two to get along. Means a lot to me."

I forced a smile, nodding. "Yeah. Me too."

We chatted for a few minutes more as my friend pretended to tell me about their London trip for the first time. As I listened and nodded, I kept watching Natasha. There was something about her—something I couldn't quite figure out. The change in her voice when she spoke about Emmie, about me filling her up every night, was startling. Where had that come from? Whatever it was, I knew I needed to be careful. Luke was my best friend, and I wasn't about to do anything that could mess that up.

Eventually, I finished my drink and stood, clapping Luke on the shoulder. "Alright, I've got to head out. Got somewhere I need to be tonight."

Luke nodded, his grin widening. "Alright, alright. Go do your thing. Thanks for coming, Ryan." Then he beckoned me forward so he could whisper in my ear. "And hey, keep this whole proposal thing to yourself, yeah?"

I laughed, nodding. "Of course. Good luck, mate."

Natasha gave me a small wave, her smile polite but her eyes still carrying that hint of something unreadable. "Tell Emmie I said hello," she said quietly. "I'd like to get to know her better too. We should do something, the four of us when we're back from London. Next week, maybe?"

"Definitely." I nodded, turning and making my way out of the pub, my mind still buzzing. What was all that about with Natasha? Luke was proposing? I hadn't seen that coming. Then again, I hadn't seen any of this coming. Emmie's revelations. Laura's forwardness and offer to help. Sophie's flirting. Natasha's innocent mask suddenly dropping. I got in my car and pulled out of the car park, my thoughts drifting back to my neighbour. I needed answers, and tonight, I was determined to get them.

The roadworks hit me just as I was halfway home, the traffic slowing to a crawl as I reached the detour signs. I cursed under my breath, drumming my fingers against the steering wheel as I weighed my options. I could sit in traffic, inching forward for the next half hour, or I could take the back route

—a longer trip, but one usually clear of traffic at this time. I checked my phone. Emmie hadn't texted to say she was finished in the meeting but it still felt like I was running out of time. I found myself taking the turn, heading towards the edge of town and the longer way around.

The evening was just settling in, the sky turning that dusky shade of blue as I drove down the road that led to the area where we lived. I was pondering once again where I'd seen Natasha before and what had provoked her change of tone when my gaze caught on a familiar figure standing near the entrance to an equally familiar glass-fronted building.

T.J.

He was standing outside the gym—Emmie's gym—with another guy, someone I didn't recognise, tall and fit-looking, with sandy hair and a boyish face. They were talking, T.J. leaning casually against his parked car, a grin on his face.

I pulled over out of curiosity, my footsteps echoing slightly in the quiet car park out front as I got out and walked over. T.J. looked up, his grin disappearing when he saw me. "Ryan! What are you doing here?"

I shrugged, trying to play it cool. "Roadworks. Thought I'd take the back way home and saw you here, so thought I'd say hello. Didn't know you worked out."

T.J. chuckled, nodding at the sports bag slung over his shoulder. "Yeah, not for long. I'm still fairly new but I'm working at trying to get into shape."

He was a lean guy, clearly fit if not obviously a gym goer.

"Emmie comes here," I told him. "She's never mentioned seeing you here."

"Does she?" T.J. shook his head and shrugged. "She must visit at a different time to me. I can't say I've seen her."

"Emmie?" His companion's blue eyes widened at the mention of my wife's name.

"Oh, this is Craig," T.J. said, gesturing toward the man beside him. "He's a trainer here. Craig, this is Ryan—Emmie's husband."

"Ah, Emmie's Ryan!" Craig's face lit up, and he extended a hand. "Nice to meet you. Emmie talks about you a lot."

I shook his hand, feeling an odd tightening in my chest. "She's mentioned you too," I said, trying to keep my tone casual.

Craig nodded, leaning against the wall again, arms crossed. "Yeah, she's a regular here." He gave T.J. a look that I couldn't decipher, then turned

back to me. "Pretty dedicated, actually. Didn't know she was married until a while back, though. Good to put a face to the name."

A flicker of something passed over T.J.'s face, and he smirked, glancing between us. "Hey Ryan, I saw you with Sophie earlier today, on the way out. Man, you have to know she's all over you, totally into you, you know?"

The comment caught me off guard. "Sophie? Yeah, she's... how she is, I suppose. She's Sophie," I said, brushing it off.

"How she is?" T.J. laughed, nudging Craig with his elbow. "She totally wants him." He looked me straight in the eye. "Come on, man. You should at least take her out one time. I mean, she's practically throwing herself at you. What's stopping you?"

I gave him a look, bewildered by his encouragement. "Uh... my marriage, for one."

T.J. just shrugged, his smile easygoing. "Yeah, yeah, of course. But I wouldn't judge if you did. Besides," he added with a knowing grin, "I know Sophie pretty well myself. Don't tell her I told you but she and I... We had a little fling once—nothing serious, just a crazy night out that ended up at my place."

Craig, seeing the look of surprise on my face, jumped in, probably eager to stop his friend getting in trouble at work. "Ah, you told me about that. It was just once, back in the day. Nothing major. Right, T.J.?"

"Yeah, exactly." T.J. waved it off, looking unbothered. "Sophie's a good time, though. And girlfriend material for the right guy. She's absolute dynamite in bed."

I forced a laugh, keeping my tone light. "Well, thanks for... the information," I said, thinking of a quick excuse to leave. I didn't need to know about T.J. and Sophie. Things were already interesting enough without even more complications to think about. "I should get going. Got a few things to take care of tonight. I just didn't want to drive by without saying hi."

They nodded, and I could feel their eyes on me as I walked back to my car, the conversation sitting uncomfortably in my mind. Something about T.J.'s encouragement felt strange, especially if he really had slept with Sophie himself. I pulled away from the gym, my thoughts swirling with questions. Craig had seemed friendly enough, but there was something in the way he'd said "Emmie talks about you a lot" that struck a nerve. Why was she talking about me to her trainer so much? Either way, Emmie had a

connection to Craig that I hadn't fully understood until now, and through him a connection to T.J. even though he'd denied it. Maybe I needed to keep my guard up around him more until I'd worked all of this out.

But right now, I needed to focus on what lay ahead. I turned onto my street, letting out a breath as I pulled up in front of the house. The plan was simple: get home, change, and head next door to finally get some answers from Laura. Whatever she'd seen, I needed to hear it directly from her.

Once inside, I quickly changed out of my work clothes, splashed cold water on my face, and took a deep breath. This was it. Tonight, I was going to find out the truth, or at least the part that Laura knew. I didn't know exactly what to expect, but the anticipation had my pulse racing as I left the house and headed next door.

As I walked down Laura's garden path, I noticed her through the window, her silhouette framed by the warm glow of the room's lights. She was dressed in a fitted black top and a short skirt that clung to her curves. Her long red hair was styled, her makeup flawless—she looked like she was either expecting someone or about to head out for the night. That small detail made my heart pound faster, an edge of nervousness creeping in. Was I walking into something bigger than I'd planned for?

Standing at her door, I took a steadying breath before knocking. She turned to see me standing outside and smiled warmly before walking out of view towards the door. The silence stretched out as I waited, each second accompanied by a loud heartbeat in my chest. This was it. Whatever she knew, whatever secrets she was holding—I was about to find out.

Chapter Seven

Laura smiled at me as she opened the door, her large brown eyes sparkling with a hint of mischief. “About time you grew a pair of balls and came over,” she teased, stepping back to let me in. Her perfume filled the small entryway, a subtle, fresh citrus scent.

I chuckled, but the nerves tightened in my chest. “Yeah, well, it would be rude not to take you up on your offer. Not very neighbourly.”

She giggled sexily, then led me through to the living room, motioning toward the sofa as she headed into the kitchen. “Beer?” she called over her shoulder, already reaching into the fridge.

“Yes, please,” I replied, grateful for something to calm my nerves. Moments later, she returned with two cold bottles and handed me one, her fingers brushing mine as she did. She settled in close on the sofa beside me, a casual intimacy that set my pulse racing.

Laura took a sip of her drink, eyeing me over the rim of her bottle. “So,” she said slowly, “I’m guessing you’re here to talk about Emmie?”

I nodded, feeling the words catch in my throat. “Yeah. It’s been on my mind ever since the other night.”

Her lips curved into a smirk as she set her beer down on the coffee table. “The other night, huh? That was fun while it lasted. Was I on your mind too?” Her voice was playful, but her eyes were serious as if she were testing me, seeing if I’d take the bait.

I took a steadying breath, knowing I needed to clear the air. “Yes, what we did was fun, but Laura—whatever Emmie did, that was when we were on a break. She wasn’t with me then, so what she did wasn’t cheating. But I’m not single now, so... it wouldn’t be right.”

She let out a small sigh, leaning back into the cushions, her gaze softening. “Fair enough. I can respect that.” She looked down at her hands for a moment before glancing back up. “So, what do you want to know?”

I felt my heart race as I sipped my beer, gathering my thoughts. “When was the first time you saw her with someone?” I asked, my voice barely a whisper. “And... who was it?”

Laura settled back on the sofa, crossing her legs and giving me a thoughtful look. “It was a few months after you’d moved out. I remember it clearly because I’d just started working on the garden more, spending more time outside. And like I told you, Mark’s rule is no smoking in the house, so I’d be out back with my cigarette, which gave me a clear view into your living room.” She shrugged, a guilty smile creeping across her lips. “Not that I was spying, of course... at least, not at first.”

I swallowed, my mouth suddenly dry. “So... who was it?”

She tilted her head, giving me an assessing look. “I honestly don’t know who they were—any of them. But I remember what they looked like.” She paused, almost as if gauging whether I really wanted to know, her gaze flicking over me. “You’re sure you want to hear this?”

“I’m sure,” I said, though my voice was rougher than I’d intended. I took a long swig of beer to calm myself, bracing for what she might say next.

Laura’s eyes sparkled with a hint of something like mischief, maybe amusement, as she leaned back. “Alright, if you really want to know... I’ll tell you what I saw. But remember, you asked for this.” She shot me a look, half-teasing, half-serious, as if daring me to stop her now.

“Just tell me,” I said, trying to sound firm even though my insides were twisted with nerves.

Laura took a breath, then began. “The first time I saw her with someone, it was late. The house was mostly dark except for a dim light in the living room. At first, I thought he might’ve been a family friend, maybe her dad or an uncle or something. He was older than her—looked to be in his forties. Greying hair, very well put together, a bit of a ‘silver fox’ if you know what I mean. I’d seen him once or twice before, coming and going. But that night was different.”

She gave me a glance, hesitating before continuing. "They were just sitting there at first, talking, I suppose. But then... he reached for her, pulled her onto his lap. And she didn't resist. Instead, she wrapped her arms around him, like you do when you're... close to someone. He leaned in, kissed her neck, and she just... melted into him."

A pang hit my chest, a dull ache twisting deeper with every word, but I said nothing, just nodded for her to go on.

"He started undressing her," Laura continued softly, her voice barely more than a whisper. "Slowly, like he was savouring every moment, so I'm guessing this was their first time together. I was standing out here, shocked but I couldn't look away. Emmie's got a great body. Big boobs, nice hips. If I was a lesbian..." She sighed dramatically, giving me a sideways look before laughing. "Anyway, the old guy didn't rush it. He went down on her and I couldn't help myself. I walked into your garden for a better view."

"And..." I prompted her continue. "I'm guessing they fucked?"

Laura's eyes flicked up to mine, checking my reaction before she continued. "He made her cum with his tongue, then he got undressed and she sucked his cock. You know, if they'd looked up at that point, they might have seen me, but they didn't. They were totally in the zone. She was giving him a blowjob and he had his head back, enjoying every moment."

My phone buzzed suddenly, breaking the tension. I glanced at the screen and saw Jen's name lighting up, her face filling the caller ID. She was video calling me, but why? It wasn't like Jen. Maybe something was up. I should answer it.

"One second," I apologised to Laura, "I need to take this but I'll only be a second."

"Don't worry about it," the redhead smiled, glancing at my screen. "But don't be long if you want the rest of the story."

I hesitated, aware of the setting I was in and who was with me. Quickly excusing myself, I turned on the sofa so that Laura was just out of view, adjusting the angle so that only the neutral background of the black leather sofa and peach painted wall showed up.

"Jen?" I said, trying to sound casual as her face appeared, slightly pixelated but unmistakably concerned. Her long blonde hair was tied back into a messy bun, and she had that look—half worried, half impatient—that I'd come to recognise over the years. Her makeup was minimal, and a hint

of frustration creased her brow, as if this call was the last thing she'd expected to have to do tonight.

"Ryan! Where are you?" she demanded, her eyes narrowing slightly. "I just called by your house, and there was no one in. I tried Emmie, but she's not picking up. Is everything alright?"

I forced a smile, hoping the background she could see looked convincingly mundane. "Yeah, everything's fine. I'm sorry we worried you. I'm just... over at a friend's house for a bit. Emmie's at a work meeting, so she's probably just tied up and can't get to the phone."

Jen's eyes narrowed further, clearly unconvinced. "A work meeting? This late? Are you sure?"

"Positive," I said, keeping my voice even. "Nate called her in for it after work. If you leave her a message, I'm sure she'll get back to you when she can."

Her eyes drifted, suspicious but probing, and she pressed on. "Which friend's house are you at? That doesn't look like Luke's house."

I held my phone steady, ensuring the background behind me was still safe, and gave her a reassuring grin, wondering why she was being so probing. I decided to tell her the truth, if not the whole truth. "I'm next door with Mark and Laura, just helping with her PC. They can't get into their emails." I added a chuckle, hoping to lighten her suspicions.

Jen's expression softened a little, though not entirely. Her hazel eyes were still searching, glancing quickly to see if there was any giveaway in my setting. "Alright. Well, tell Emmie to give me a ring when she's done. I just... wanted to check in."

I nodded, relieved she was satisfied with my explanation. "Will do. Thanks for looking out for us, Jen. I'm sorry we worried you."

She nodded slowly, her gaze lingering on me as if she still had doubts, before finally ending the call. As the screen went dark, I released a slow breath, my nerves rattled. I slipped my phone back into my pocket, suddenly aware of Laura's amused gaze.

"Problems with my emails, huh?" She licked her lips, chuckling to herself. "If you want to see my inbox, you only have to ask."

I couldn't help but laugh at the joke but I needed to get back to business.

"Where were we? Oh yeah. She gave this guy a blowjob. Was he big?" I asked, unable to believe I was asking such a thing but here we were. "His cock? Was he muscular? Skinny?"

"I've seen bigger," Laura shrugged. "But, yeah, I guess. A decent size for an older guy. You really do want to know every detail don't you?"

I nodded but clenched my jaw, trying to keep my composure. "So, then what? Did they go up to the bedroom?"

"No, he rolled her onto her back on the sofa and put it inside her but eventually, they ended up on the floor," she went on, her voice even softer. "He fucked her missionary, slowly and then she got on top, slowing things down. But then he got back on top and they were at it so fast they fell onto the floor and I just watched them fuck like that until he came. He pulled out and came on her boobs, like Mark does with me. He loves doing that."

I couldn't help but glance at her chest. Her black top was tight enough to show the lacy detail of her bra through the thin fabric. The top two buttons were undone, giving a hint of her creamy pale cleavage.

She paused, noticing my stare but she didn't mention it. "You sure you're alright, Ryan?"

"Just keep going," I said, my voice low, every word feeling like a fight to get out.

"Once he'd cum, I moved away. I wasn't bothered if they saw me, but the sight had made me horny," she grinned. "So I came home and used one of my sex toys. I have quite the collection. I'll show you some time, if you're interested?"

"I... need to know what else happened," I said, stammering slightly. My cock was aching in my shorts. Why was I so turned on hearing what Emmie did. "Did she see this old guy again?"

"I saw him come and go a couple of times," Laura nodded, "But I never saw them fuck. If they did it, they did it somewhere else, not the living room or bedroom. Then he stopped coming over. I don't know why."

"But you saw her with someone else? Some other guys?"

Laura sighed, a small, apologetic smile tugging at her lips. "The next time, it was different. She wasn't as... open, I guess. This guy was younger—dark-haired, more your age. Strong build, very... commanding. The thing is, she looked kind of nervous this time, like she wasn't sure she should be doing it. I was in the garden and saw them in the living room together. She kept glancing toward the window as if she was afraid of being seen, so I had to watch more discretely."

I forced myself to breathe, steady and slow. "What happened?"

“She was wearing this tight little black dress, like she was ready to go out. Maybe he was going to take her to dinner but they got... distracted. Anyway, one minute they were talking then the next, he had his hands all over her, pulling her close and they kissed. I thought, 'Here we go, I'm going to see Emmie get fucked again,' but I didn't. She let him undress her, but when he tried to go further, tried to move her to the sofa like the old guy did, she stopped him. Gave him this soft push back and said something I couldn't catch. He looked annoyed but backed off.”

"So they didn't do anything?"

“They were talking, I don't know what was being said. He was fully dressed, she was standing there in just a pair of tiny panties and there was this tension between them—I was sure they were going to fuck. It was clear he wanted her, and I got the feeling she was tempted, but all that happened is that knelt down in front of him, got his dick out and sucked him.”

Her words landed heavily, each one twisting the knife a little deeper. But I stayed quiet, listening, needing to hear it all.

"I watched her drain every drip of cum from him. She swallowed. Then she got up, got dressed and something else was said. Then he left. It was very weird. It's the one time I've wondered about the most. I don't know who he was or what happened, but maybe you'll be able to find out one day and tell me."

I stared at her, my mouth dry, but she continued.

She took another breath. “I didn't see the dark-haired guy after that, so I don't know what went down. The last guy was... different from the other two again. He was younger, very fit, and I'd seen him somewhere before, though I couldn't tell you where. He's local, probably. A tall, blonde guy—well built. And handsome.” She glanced at me, her lips quirking slightly before she continued. “Very handsome. Anyway, this time, there was no hesitation, no nerves. I was out here having a cigarette and saw them walk into the room and they just went for it.”

My heart pounded in my chest. That sounded like Craig who'd I only just met less than an hour ago. “They went for it?”

She gave me a steady look. “You know what I mean. Kissing passionately, his hands tangled in her hair, her arms around his neck. They were... completely into it. Didn't waste any time. Practically ripped each other's clothes off.”

"What was she wearing?" I asked, my voice raspy.

Laura's eyes narrowed for a moment, trying to remember. "A hoodie top, I think? Him too but I'm not sure. You really do like hearing the details, don't you?"

She slid a hand up my thigh to where my cock sat, pressing painfully against my trousers. She felt the hardness and her eyes flickered up to meet mine. "You should let me deal with this for you."

I swallowed deeply, resisting the temptation. "Just finish telling me about the third guy."

"If you insist," she sighed. "I don't know if this is what you wanted to hear, but this guy... He fucked the crap out of her, Ryan. His dick was huge. His body was ripped. He tossed her around the living room, fucked her from behind, on top, against the wall, over the arm of the sofa... every position you can think of. She must have orgasmed a dozen times. I was so jealous, I almost walked over to knock on the window and ask when it was my turn."

She giggled but then trailed off, meeting my gaze with a sympathetic look. "I didn't see him cum because they seemed to take a break, then they went upstairs. The bedroom light came on but she closed the curtains so I could see anything, but Ryan, I could hear everything. The window was open and all I could hear for the next half an hour was her moaning and crying out. Whoever that young man was, he gave her a hell of a good time."

My jaw tightened again as her words settled in, each one landing like a fresh blow. "And was it just that one time with him too?"

Laura reached over, placing a gentle hand on my arm. "I'm sorry, Ryan. I really am, but no, I saw him a couple of times, coming and going to the house and each time, I either caught a glimpse of heard them fucking."

I nodded stiffly, though inside I was barely holding it together.

The vibration of my phone snapped me out of whatever trance Laura had pulled me into. I blinked, trying to clear my head, and glanced down at the message lighting up my screen as I pulled it from my pocket.

Hey babe, just a quick message. This meeting's busier than I thought, so I might be a while yet. Guess who's here? Ethan, my old boss, and Mitch. He's an old client of Nate's and doing some business with Ethan. It's such a small world that you're managing Mitch's account and now I run into him.

A small world. It certainly was. What the hell was going on?

“You alright?” Laura’s voice cut through my thoughts, soft but laced with something else... Was it sympathy? Concern? Jealousy? I glanced up, meeting her eyes, and found them dark and unreadable.

“Yeah,” I muttered, barely recognizing my own voice. But the word felt empty, and Laura must have seen it. Her gaze softened as she leaned closer, her fingers finding my forearm, tracing gentle patterns that made my skin tingle.

“Ryan,” she murmured, tilting her head with a look that was part empathy, part something far less innocent. Her hand slid slowly down my arm, drifting over my stomach until her fingers were at the waistband of my trousers. “You’re turned on, aren’t you? Turned on by knowing what Emmie did.”

Her hand slid lower, and I felt her fingers slide into my shorts, sending a rush of conflicted desire through me. My heart pounded, and I opened my mouth, but the words died on my lips as she gave me a look that was both a question and an answer.

“Laura...” I managed, but my voice was barely a whisper, almost pleading. “I’m married.”

“Shh,” she murmured, her fingers deftly undoing my belt, then my zip. “I think you want this almost as much as I do.”

She pulled out my cock, which was already fully hard, her fingers exploring the length of it slowly. I sucked in a breath, feeling myself throb beneath her touch, the tension that had been building for days finally snapping free in one reckless release. I could have stopped her... but I didn’t.

She didn’t wait long. In a seamless movement, she leaned down, her warm breath ghosting over my skin as she took me into her mouth. A soft gasp escaped me as her lips closed around the head, her tongue tracing slow, agonizing circles around it. My hands gripped the couch, every nerve ending tingling as she moved, my mind blank except for this—this release, this forbidden thrill, this escape from the mess in my head.

I closed my eyes, trying to lose myself in it, her mouth moving over me, sliding down then pulling back, her lips creating a slow, steady rhythm. But just as I was on the brink of surrender, a voice shattered the silence.

“If you’re going to fuck her, Ryan, I’d get on with it. We’re supposed to be going out tonight, and I’d prefer it if you didn’t get any cum on her top or skirt.”

My eyes flew open, my heart stopping as I looked up to see Mark at the bottom of the staircase, arms crossed, an amused expression on his face. He watched us with a lazy smirk, as if this were just another ordinary evening for him. How long had he been there?

I tensed, instinctively moving to pull away, but Laura held me in place, her lips sliding off me just enough to murmur, "Mark... You scared him. Say sorry."

Her husband's gaze shifted to me, his smirk widening. "And here I was, thinking you'd never make your move, Ryan." He gave a small, mocking shrug. "But hey, all's fair in love and... neighbourly benefits."

"Mark," I stammered, my mind scrambling for some response, any response, but Laura's hand slid up my thigh, her grip firm, keeping me anchored to the spot.

"Ryan, it's fine," she whispered, giving me a lingering look. Her other hand caressed me slowly, her touch impossible to ignore. "Stay. Finish what we started. Mark likes to watch sometimes."

I felt my heart pound, the tangled mess of shock and arousal clouding my thoughts. Mark simply leaned back against the wall, watching, as if waiting to see what I'd do.

Laura's hand slid to my hips, pulling my trousers further down and then she stood unexpectedly, lifting her skirt and shimmying out of her panties.

"What are you doing?" I hissed at her, my pulse racing as she shifted, kneeling on the sofa, swinging a leg over me. "You've earned this," she murmured, grabbing my cock and rubbing it against the heat between her legs. I looked down. Her pussy was mostly smooth apart from a small tuft of fine, reddish hair atop her mound. She adjusted slightly, putting the hard head of my erection against her small pink folds, then she pushed down, taking me inside her.

I gasped as I entered her, scarcely able to believe what was happening as she began to fuck me. Her movements were slow, intentional, her big brown eyes meeting mine with a look that was both inviting and challenging.

Mark, still leaning against the wall with an unbothered expression, continued to talk as we fucked. "You know, the one time I saw Emmie fuck... let's just say, I could see why you're hung up on her. Gorgeous. That body of hers... Those big tits..." His voice trailed off with a low laugh. "She was with the young blonde guy that Laura mentioned. They were in

your bedroom, lights low... and then off... but not before we got a good view of them fucking on all fours on your bed."

"I saw her and called Mark out to watch," Laura told me, undoing two more buttons on her top so I could see her cleavage, trapped in a lacy, see-through bra. She kept fucking me as Mark continued.

"We might have only seen them fucking for a few minutes before they stopped and turned off the lights, but they didn't shut the window, so we could hear them fuck. He was banging her so hard we could practically hear his balls slapping on her ass from the back patio."

My mind swirled as I listened, the details hitting me in waves. Hearing about Emmie like this, while Laura's tight pussy was sliding up and down my cock, only added to the confusion and conflicted thrill coursing through me. Her hands pressed against my chest, her gaze softer now as she moved in closer, her lips pressing to mine. There was something reassuring in the kiss, like this wasn't just me cheating, like we both wanted this moment between us, like it made it okay.

"I remember hearing her cum," Mark chuckled. "Wailed like a fucking banshee. Lucky guy, whoever he was, getting to fuck your Emmie like that."

That was the last straw. My cock exploded before I could warn Laura, pulsing my seed deep inside her but she didn't stop. She kept riding me, pulling away and giving me a knowing look and a soft smile that meant she knew I'd cum. Only when my cock finished throbbing inside her did she sit up, smiling at her husband before slipping away to the bathroom to clean up.

My fingers trembled as I tucked my shirt back in, trying to gather some semblance of composure until Mark's voice broke the awkward silence.

"You know, Ryan... I'll be honest with you. I tried it on with Emmie myself. A few weeks after I'd seen her with the guy. I thought she might be up for some fun, but she turned me down." He gave a small shrug. "Something in her had changed. We ended up having a beer and a chat and when Laura joined us, she was still in love with you. She started talking about you a lot, saying how you'd been back in touch with her and how she couldn't get you out of her head."

I stared, trying to process it all, each word hitting me with a new wave of confusion. "You mean... she told you she still had feelings for me? This was... when?"

Mark nodded. "Yeah. It was a few weeks before you got back together. Laura and I nudged her to give you a chance, and see if you two could work things out. I don't know what had happened, maybe something with the young guy, but she wasn't herself, not until she came back to you."

I felt a strange sense of gratitude that the two people in the room with me had encouraged Laura to give our marriage a second chance but right now the feeling of guilt at what I'd just done with Laura was overwhelming. "Thanks," I managed, my voice hoarse. "I guess I owe you one."

Mark clapped me on the shoulder, his grip firm. "No worries. And hey," he grinned, "Whatever's going on now, whatever's happened that made you suddenly interested in her past, don't forget that you've got a good thing. Don't let it slip through your fingers. Don't let the things she did in the past have any bearing on your present."

"If it makes you feel any better," Laura said, returning to the living room to stand by her husband, "I haven't seen her bring any men to the house since the last time with that blonde guy, before she got back with you. I'm certain she hasn't cheated on you since you got back together."

"I think she probably got whatever she needed out of her system," Mark nodded.

That was good to hear but at the same time, it made things worse. I'd cheated. I'd let Laura seduce me, fuck me, while her husband watched. What the hell was I thinking?

"Anyway, I'd love to stay here all night and chat," Mark continued.

"—or fuck again—" Laura added, making her husband laugh.

"Or yes, fuck again," he continued, "But we're meeting some friends for dinner, so..."

"Sure, I'll get going," I replied, standing up to leave. Laura leaned in and kissed me softly on the lips as I walked towards the door, the events of tonight heavy on my mind.

"Thank you," she murmured softly. "Don't worry. I'm not going to say anything to Emmie. She enjoyed herself while you weren't around. You deserved a bit of fun too. And I've wanted to fuck you since the first day I saw you. You're cute."

She booped me on the nose with a slender finger and giggled. I felt my face reddening.

"Okay, well have a good night." With one last look, I nodded to both of them, excusing myself out of the back door, into the cool night air, each

step back to my house feeling thunderous, like I was some sort of cheating monster stomping all over my marriage. What had I done?

The house was silent when I entered, so I turned on the TV, needing some sort of noise or something to distract myself. I hadn't texted Emmie back, hadn't replied to her message about the meeting and about Mitch being there but as I pulled out my phone to message her, I noticed a new notification. An email. I took a shaky breath as I double-clicked on it, my pulse quickening with each passing second. The subject line was blank, but the style of throwaway email address was all too familiar by now. I opened the message, my eyes skimming over the text as a chill ran down my spine.

Here is the last part of the video. But it isn't the only video. There are others. I wanted to take my time with this, but the events of tonight have changed things.

I felt my mouth go dry, my heart in my mouth as I read on, dreading what would come next.

Enjoy seeing what a slut your wife was while you were away. Then, if you want to know everything and see the other videos, meet me next week. I'll send you a date, time, and place in the next email. Don't disappoint me. Be there and we'll talk.

My mind spun, grasping at possibilities. *The events of tonight have changed things.* What happened tonight to push this forward? Was this a message from Mark and Laura, some twisted game they were playing after everything that had happened? Or was it someone who knew more than I'd realised? Mitch had seen Emmie in the meeting tonight—could it be him? Or Natasha? Was she somehow trying to play me after the weird encounter earlier?

Questions tangled together, too many to untangle in one go. I stared at the screen, the words blurring slightly as a sense of worry settled over me, my mind teetering on the edge of panic.

And then, just below the email message, I saw it. The attachment—a video file, waiting to be opened. The thumbnail was of Emmie, naked on the bed, on all fours, her face turned to look over her shoulder at whoever was about to fuck her.

My finger hovered over the play button. Did I really want to see this? Did I really want to know anything further? Look at where this had taken me, this obsession with her past. It had led me to cheating, led me to fuck our

next-door neighbour and who knew what complications that was going to cause further down the line.

I should leave this well alone. Delete the video. Ignore any future emails. I should tell Emmie everything. Come clean. Put this behind us.

But I didn't.

My finger hovered over the screen again. And then pressed play.

Afterword

Thank you for joining me on this journey with Ryan and Emmie. I hope you're as engrossed in their tangled story as I am in writing it. With each new layer of secrets, the stakes grow higher, and the consequences edge closer.

Now, as we reach the end of this second book, so many questions linger. Who is sending these videos, and what do they stand to gain from haunting Ryan with Emmie's past? What more could they be hiding, and how far will they go to reveal it? And Emmie—what other secrets might she be keeping, knowingly or unknowingly?

Laura, Jen, Luke, Mitch, and even Natasha... who can Ryan truly trust as he inches toward the truth? Has Emmie indeed left her past behind, or is she still hiding something from Ryan?

And as Ryan grapples with the jealousy and fascination the videos have stirred in him, he finds himself drawn to darker places within. But will he find the strength to hold onto his marriage—or will this journey unravel everything he thought he knew about love, loyalty, and desire?

Once again, thank you for reading! Your support means everything, and I can't wait to share what's next. Stay tuned—Ryan's search for answers is far from over.

Also by Paul Garland

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About The Author

Paul Garland is an author of erotic novels and short stories, guaranteed to keep you turning the lust-filled pages until the early hours of the night. He lives with his wife and two children in a small house in the suburbs of Sheffield, England along with a lazy green budgerigar, an African Grey parrot that curses and a tubby tabby cat which would love to eat either. (Preferably the vulgar-tongued parrot.)

He has been writing since the turn of the millennium but only turned to the erotica genre in 2018 with his *Cerulean Erotica Presents* series and *No Angels* series of books which rapidly gained him a following. In 2020, he began 'The Cuckold Collection,' a brand new collection of cuckold-themed books and two new series of shorter stories: *The No Angels Stories*, *The Sexy Season Stories* and *The Cerulean Archives*. 2022 began two series, *Holiday Hotwives* and *A Size Queen Story* and 2023 introduced a new series, *Improper Investigations* and the return to the *Cerulean Archives* with *I Found A Box Of Photos Of My Wife... And Her Ex*. 2024 sees another new series along with continuations of his current running series, the *My Wife* series and the return of *The Detective Hotwife*.

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